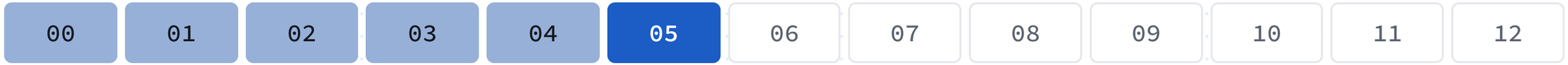
MODULE 05 · AMBITIOUS ENTREPRENEURSHIP

# The Solution Space

Of all the ways to solve this problem, why this one?

COURSE PATH



COURSE MATERIAL · SCAN NOW

# All slides live on GitHub

The newest version, free, no account needed

github.com/BaNburger/
AmbitiousEntrepreneurship

1. **Open the link**
   github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship
2. **Go to modules**
   then 05-solution-space
3. **Click the lecture PDF**
   M05_Lecture_Solution-Space.pdf, download top right

Public course repository of Ambitious Entrepreneurship. The QR code opens github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship.

WHERE WE ARE · THE COURSE

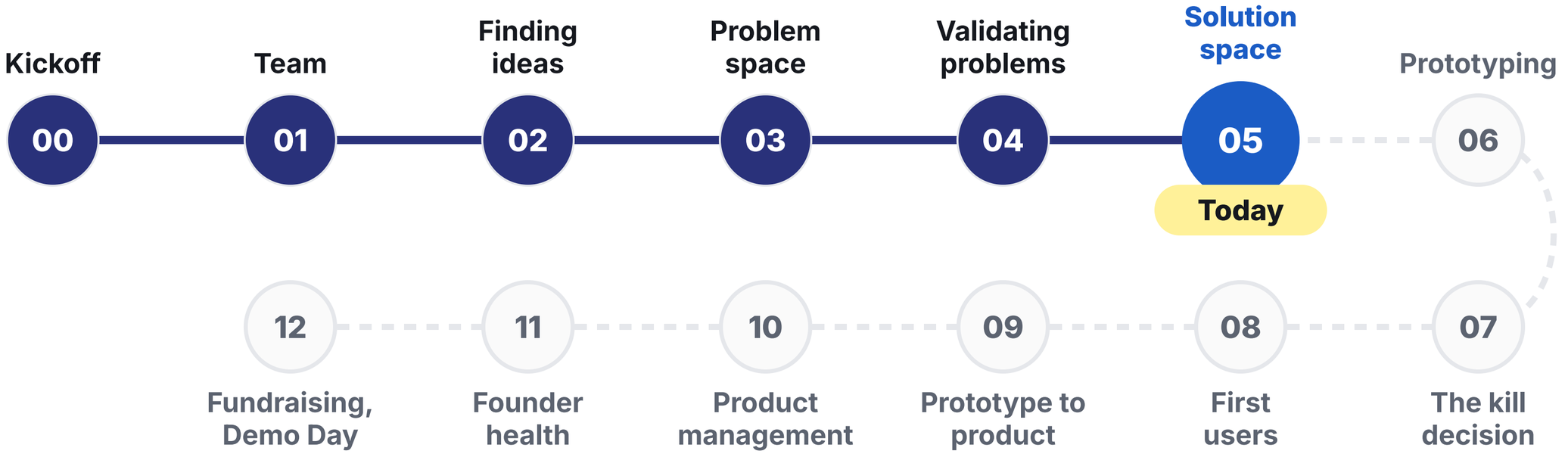
# From one problem to many solutions

Thirteen sessions from first idea to first revenue. What teams have by now:

**A problem people confirmed**
Problem space (M03)

**A landing page with its line**
Validating problems (M04)

**Sign-ups from their segment**
Validating problems (M04)



CHECK-IN · SHOW OF HANDS

# Did your page beat your line?

Hands up for your band. One click on the band per hand

## Above

**the line**

your page beat it

## Under

**the line**

a result, not a failure

## No line

**written**

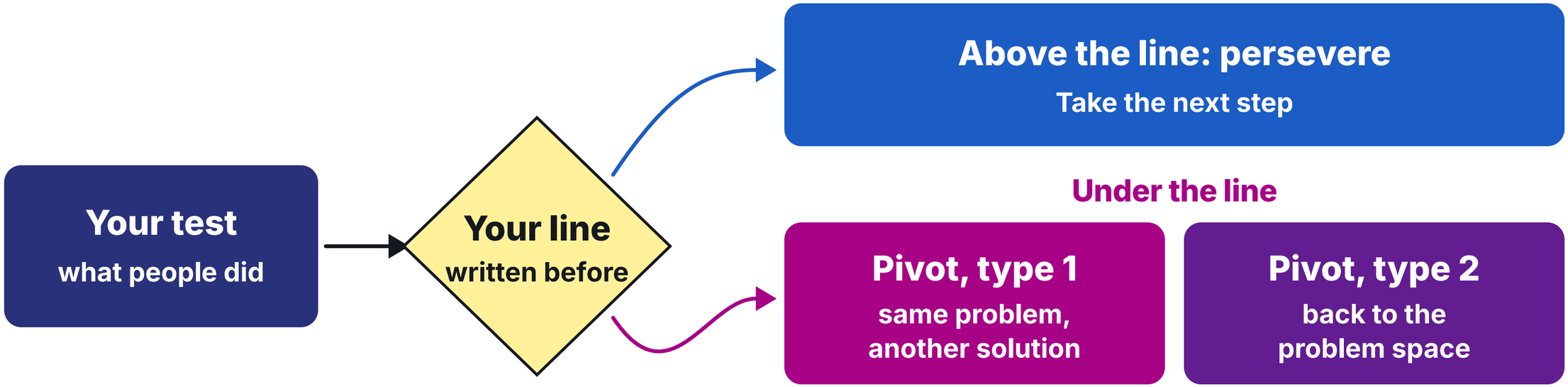
draw it first next time

2:00

PIVOT OR PERSEVERE

# Under your line? That is a decision, not a failure

Every test ends in one of two moves, and both are progress




**Both are progress. The only miss: no line, so no decision**

**FRAMEWORK** Pivot or persevere after Ries, E. (2011), The Lean Startup. Pivot types as in the course Glossary.

ACCOUNTABILITY

# Three questions, every session

**1**

**User interactions?**

What did you learn?

**2**

**New revenue?**

Why did they pay?

**3**

**Shipped?**

Why does it matter?

🦄 **Report target vs. actual in small groups**

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

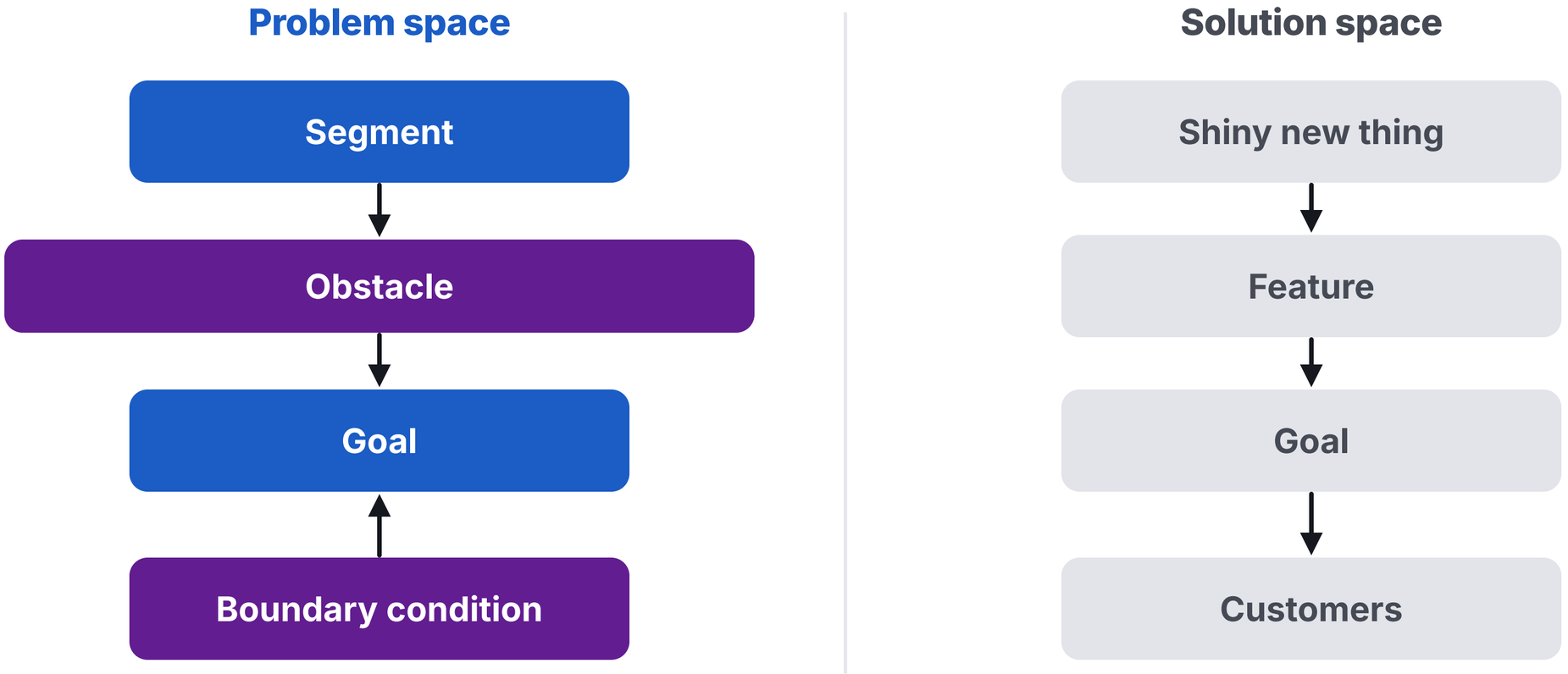
# Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

Four pictures from earlier sessions that you need to follow today.


01 **Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship**
02 Your presentations
03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**
04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**
05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**
06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos
09 Case discussion

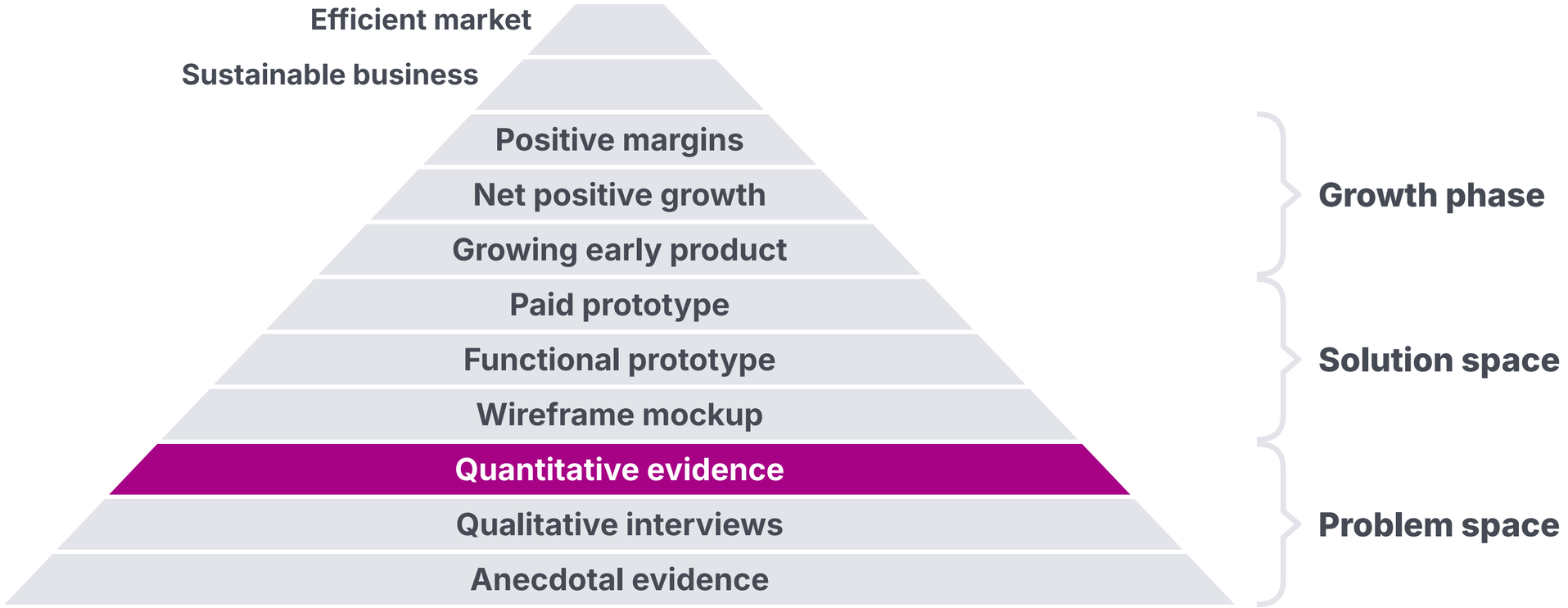
PREVIOUSLY · PROBLEM SPACE (M03)

# You started left. Today, the right side



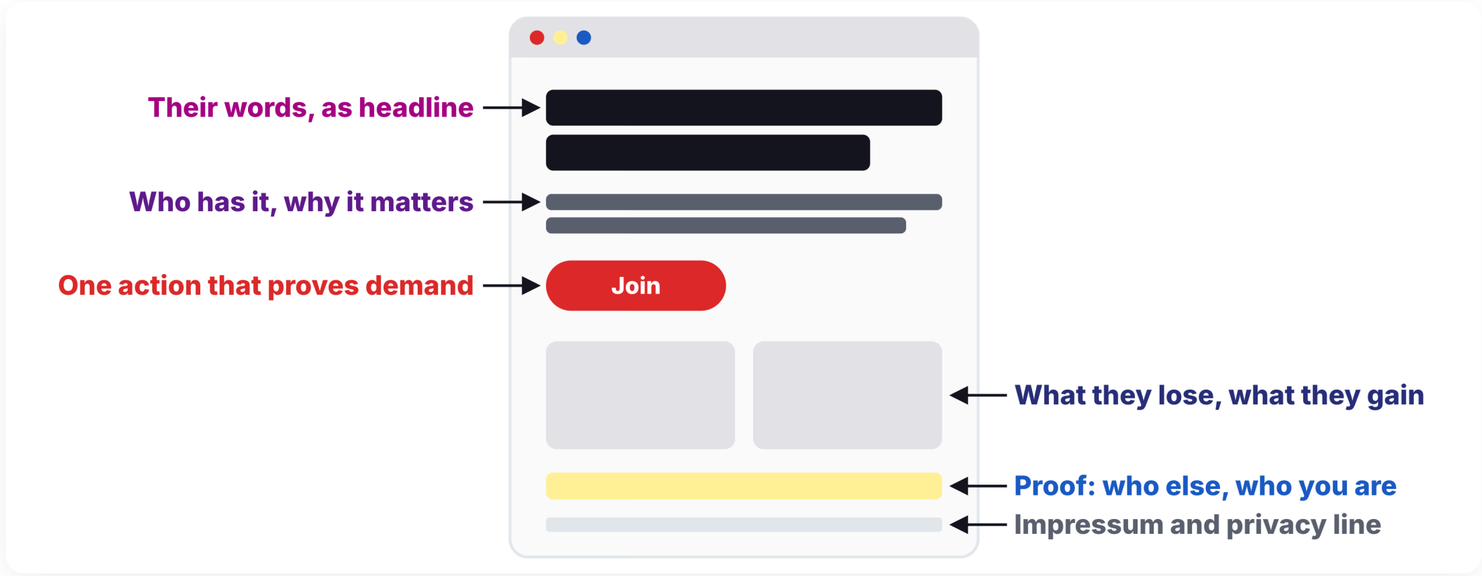
PREVIOUSLY · VALIDATING PROBLEMS (M04)

# You climbed to a number



PREVIOUSLY · VALIDATING PROBLEMS (M04)

# Your page asked for one action




Next, it leads to your click dummy, a clickable mock-up with nothing behind it.

PREVIOUSLY · VALIDATING PROBLEMS (M04)

# Real validation comes through the credit card



TODAY'S QUESTION · HANDS

# Of all the ways to solve this problem, why this one?

1:00

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

# Your presentations

Your line next to your number, three minutes per team.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 **Your presentations**

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

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YOUR PRESENTATIONS · MAKE IT CREDIBLE

# Show us where you're at in 3 minutes or less!

3:00

### Facts

**Statistics or research**

The benchmark behind your line

### 12 Numbers

**Your Toolkit**

Line next to your rate

Visitors per student

Conversion per source

### Quotes

**Sign-up calls**

Two "why did you sign up?"

### Images

**Screenshots**

Page above the fold

Analytics by source

**Verdict: pass or fail, and what it triggered**

**What did you do?**

**What did you learn?**

**How can we help?**

INPUT 1 OF 4 · CHAPTER 3 OF 9

# Widen it: many solutions to one problem

Write several solutions to your tested problem, then let what people do pick one.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

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09 Case discussion

INPUT 1 OF 4 · WIDEN IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# Before you pick: how many solutions?

**1**

**Why write several solutions before you pick one?**

**2**

**How do you pick the winner?**

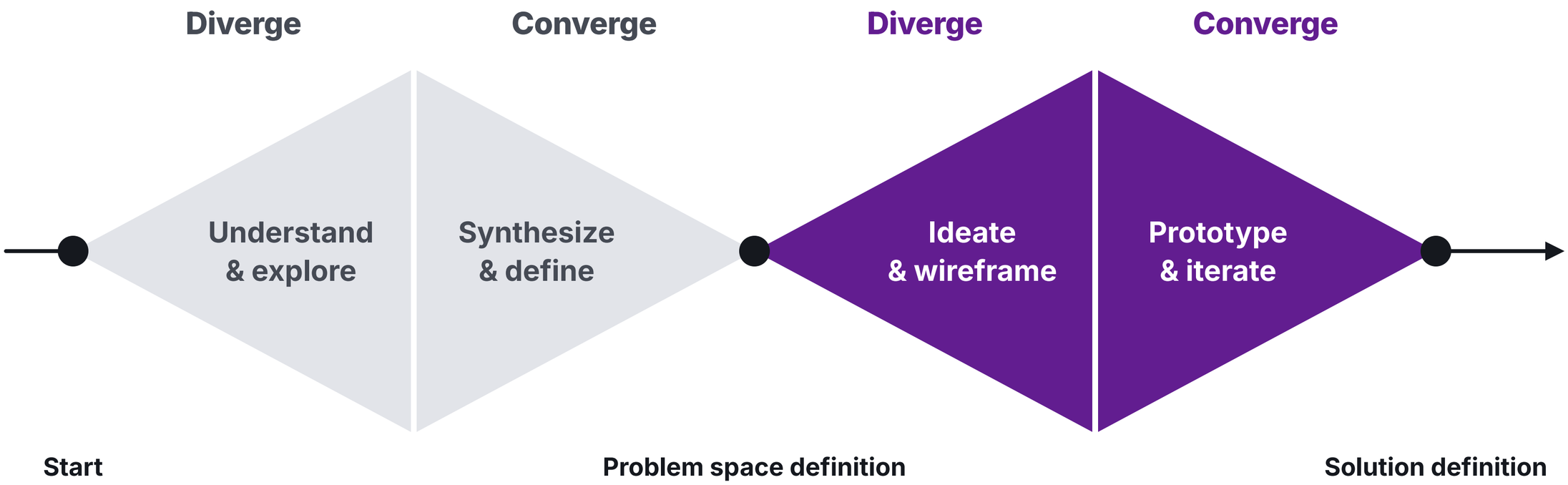
**3**

**What if every solution falls under your line?**

FROM PROBLEM SPACE TO SOLUTION SPACE

# The second diamond is today

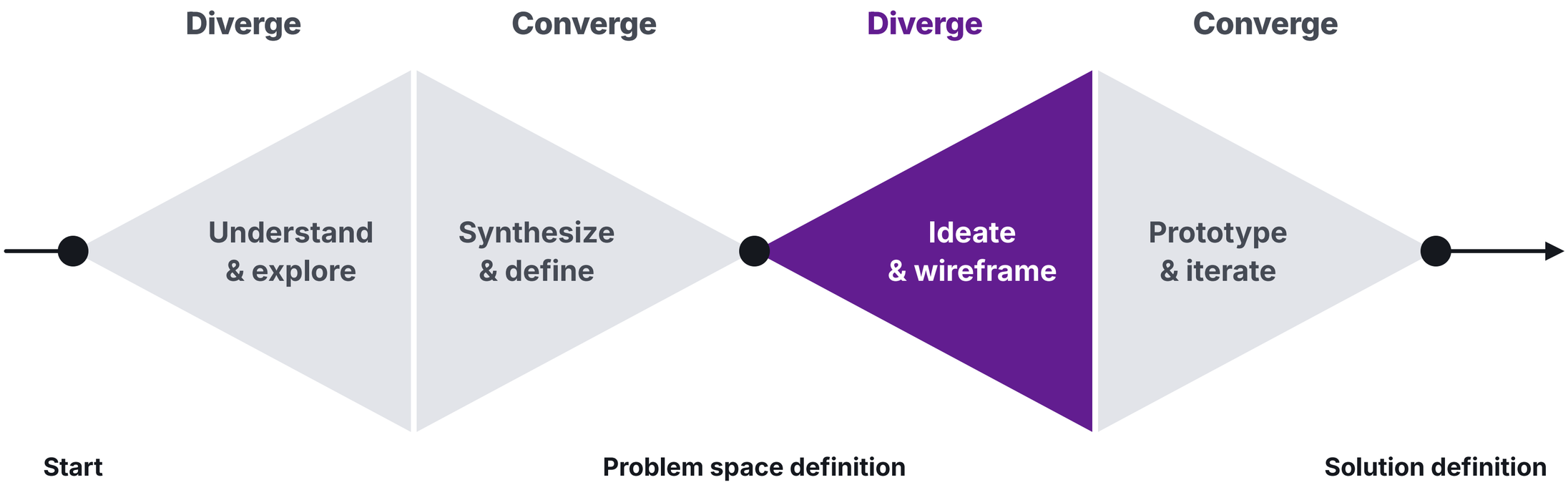
Same discipline as Finding ideas (M02), now for solutions

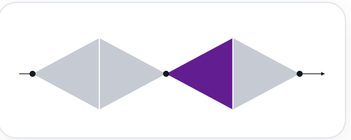


DIVERGENT THINKING

# Go wide before you go deep

Several solutions to one tested problem

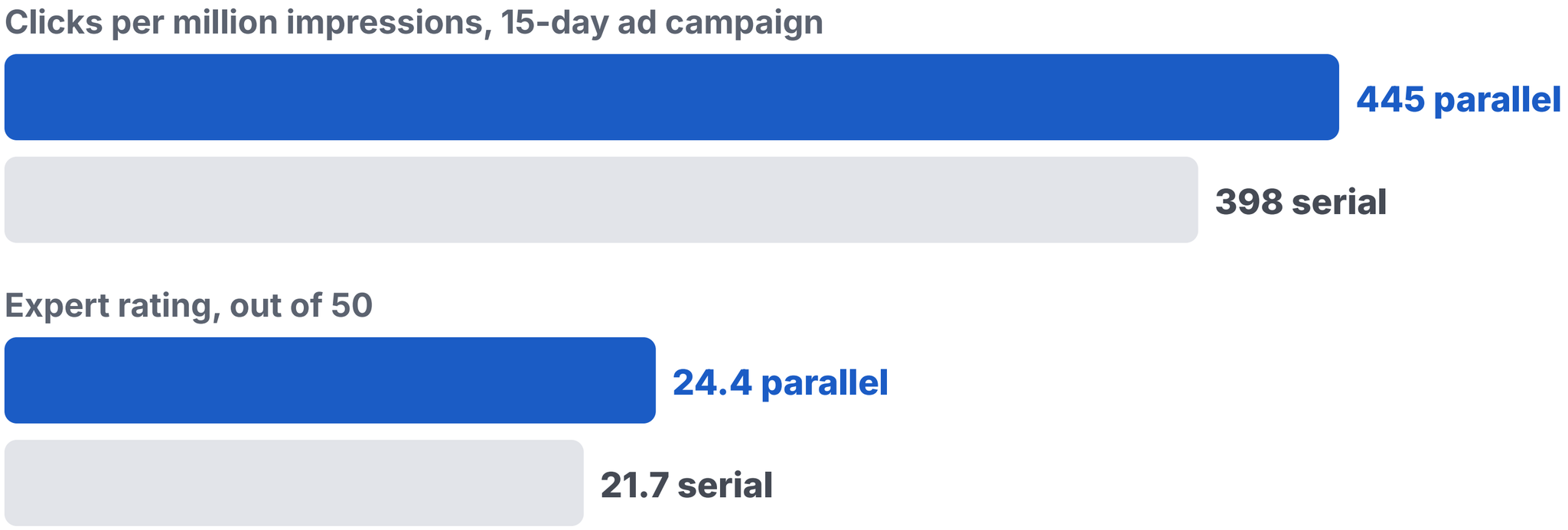




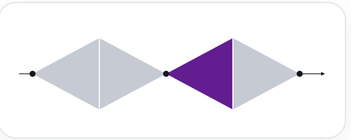
WHY IT MATTERS

# Side by side beats one by one

Same number of prototypes, same time, same feedback, 33 designers




**RESEARCH** Dow, S. P., et al. (2010). Parallel prototyping leads to better design results, more divergence, and increased self-efficacy. *ACM TOCHI*, 17(4).



WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP

# Three solutions, one without software

**SOFTWARE**



## An app

flags finalists
who went quiet

**SERVICE**



## A recruiter

calls every finalist
on day 2

**NO-CODE**



## A WhatsApp

check-in sent
by hand, daily

**Status quo: a spreadsheet and a Friday check, finalists lost after a week**

**ILLUSTRATIVE** Made-up recruiting venture, as in the Validating problems (M04) workshop.

HOW-TO · AI IDEATION

# Use AI to go wide, never to decide

```
Help me create a value
proposition for this painpoint:
[your painpoint]
1) Explore it. Look for
counterintuitive problems
   nobody has paid attention to
yet.
2) Search for existing
solutions. Summarize them.
3) Brainstorm a value
proposition that differs
   from all of them.
```

1. Paste your painpoint
2. Ask what exists
3. **Ask what differs**
4. Keep 3

AI widens the list. Your segment picks.

NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

# Write three solutions, one without software

**Status quo** — What do they use today, at what cost?

**Solution A** — The one you came in with

**Solution B** — One with no code at all

**Ask AI** — Three more you'd never think of

3:00

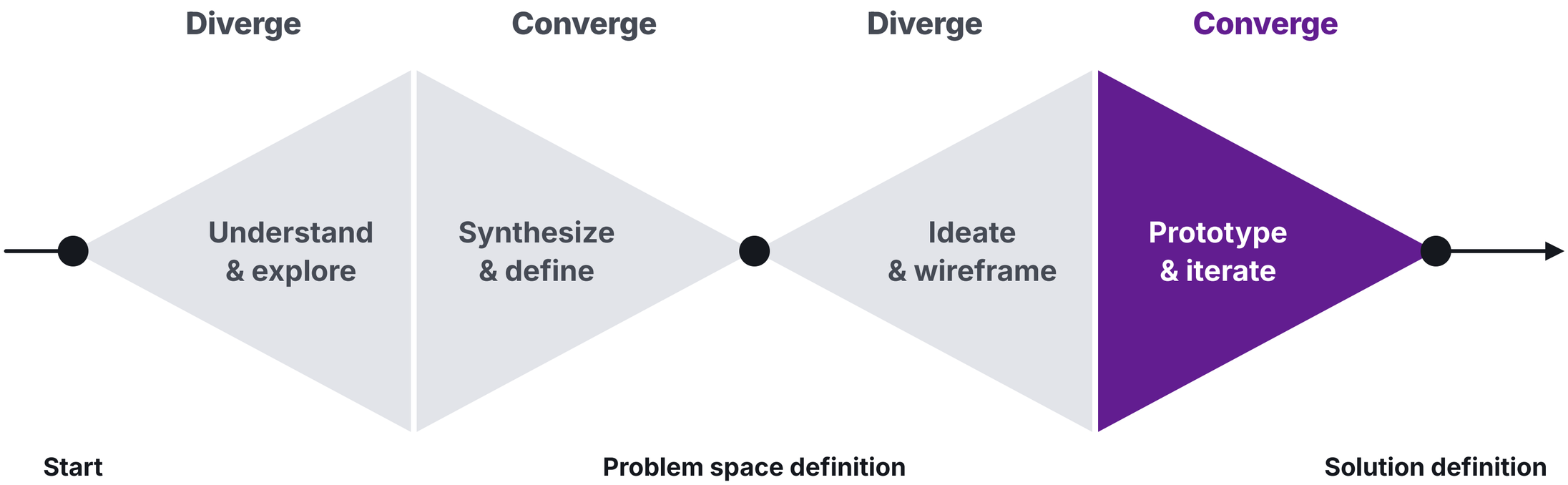
OUTPUT

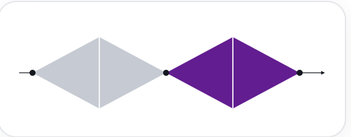
**Three solutions per founder**

CONVERGENT THINKING

# Converge by what people did

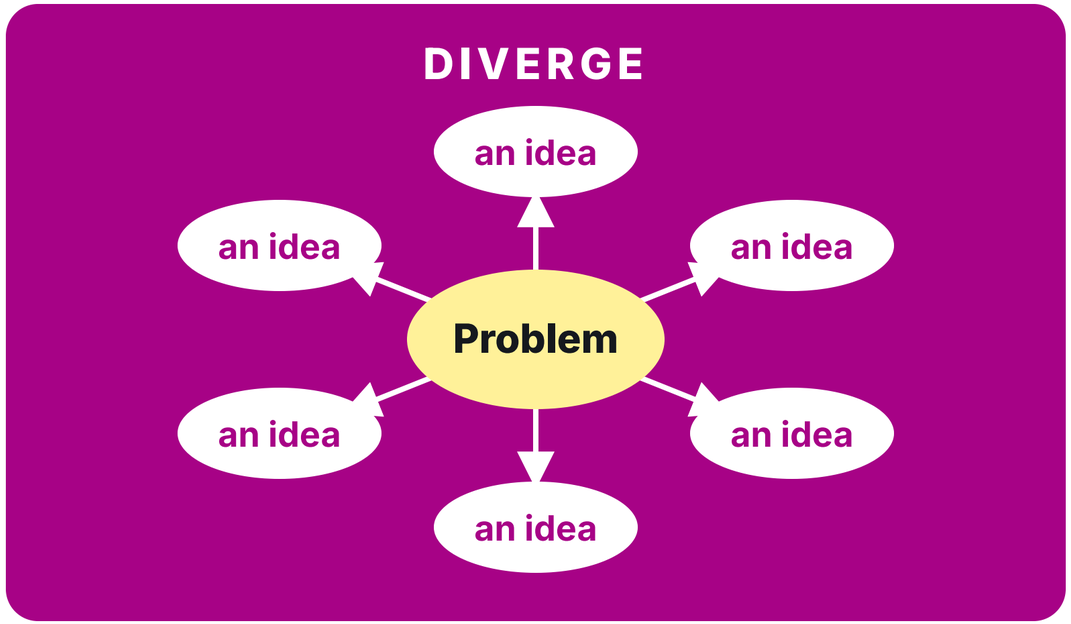
Not by what you like. Against a kill line set first

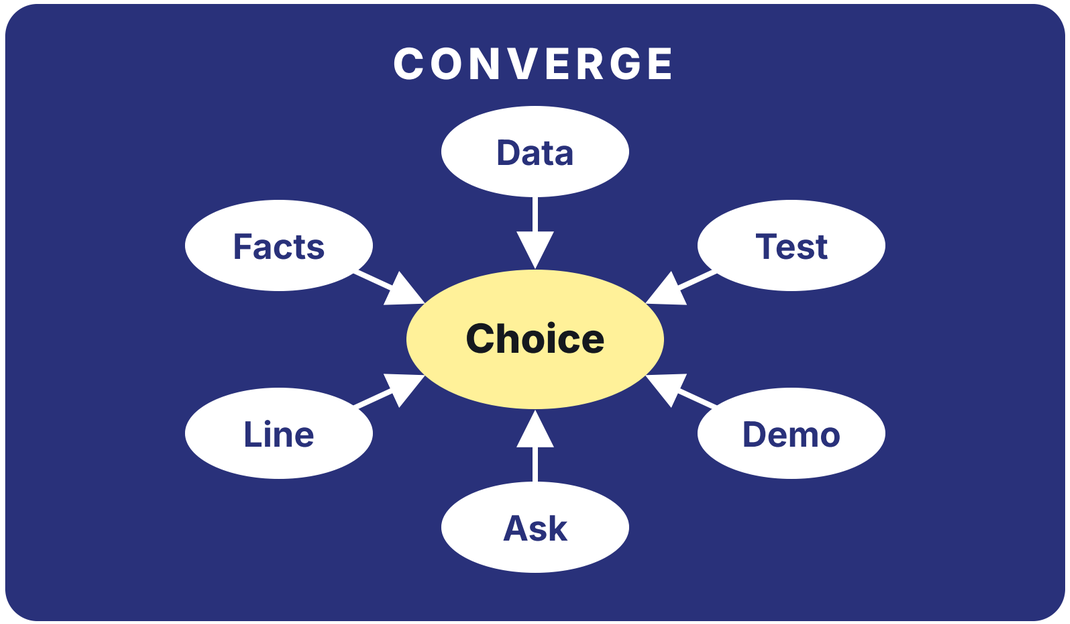


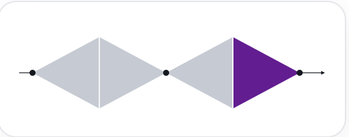


DIVERGENCE VS. CONVERGENCE

# Diverge with ideas. Converge with data

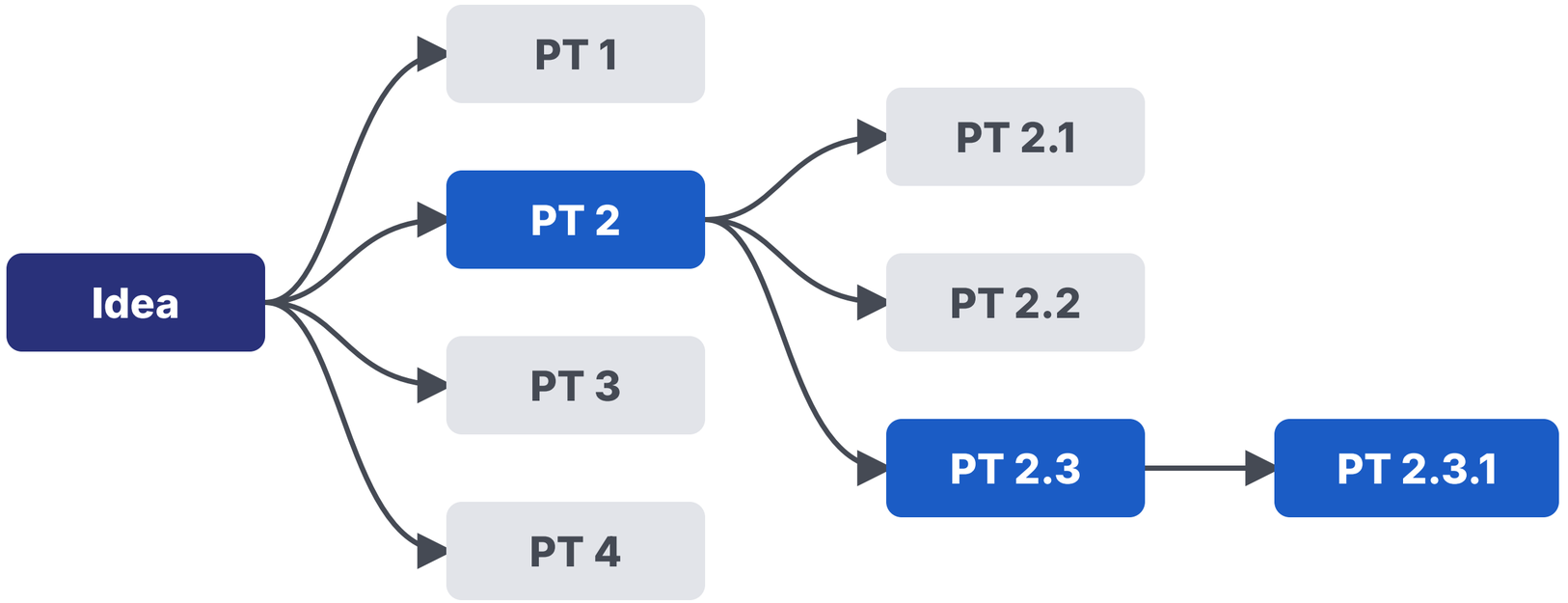




EVOLUTIONARY PROTOTYPING

# One dummy per founder. The line picks the winner




**Every founder builds 1 dummy in 4 hours**

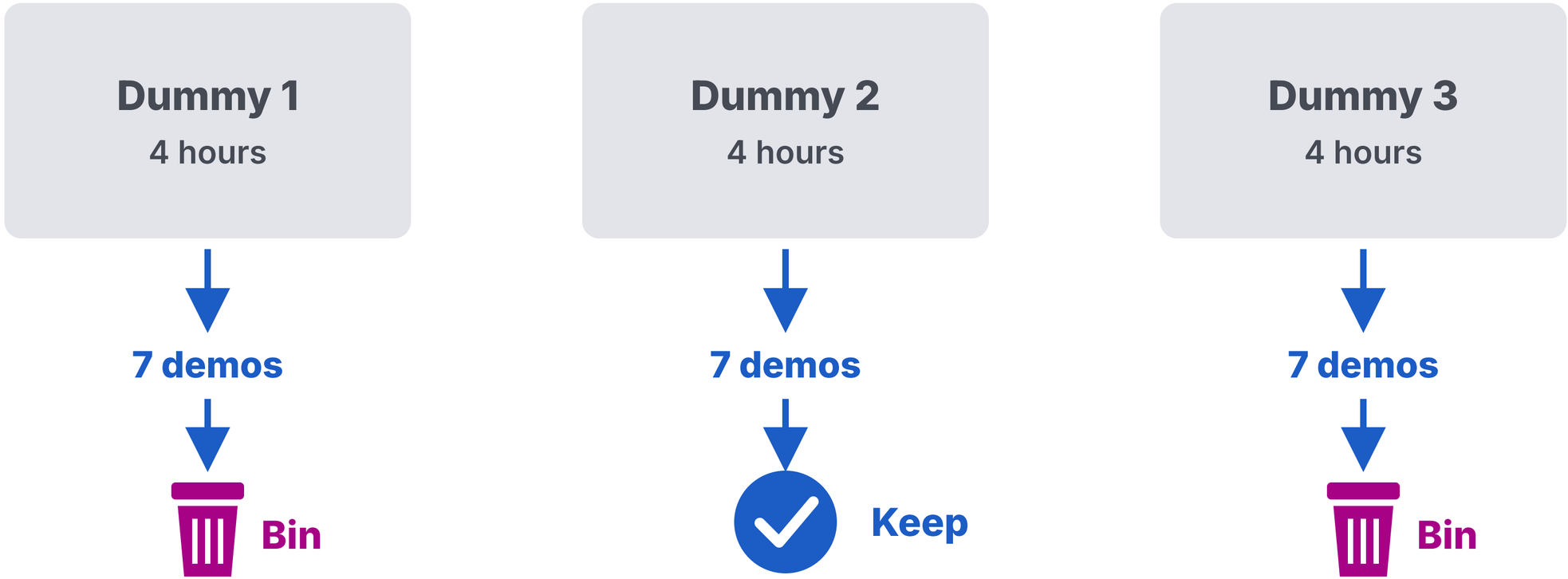
**Set the line first**

**7 demos each, then decide**

NOTE

# Your first dummies are made to be thrown away

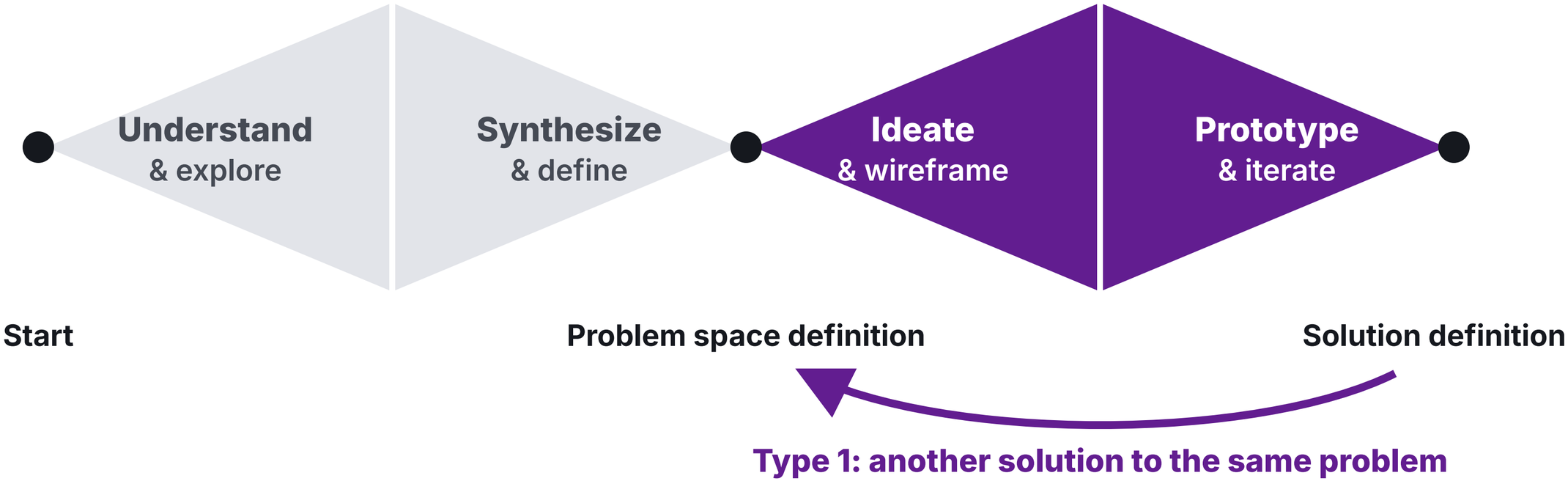
Done is better than perfect



PIVOTING · TYPE 1

# A type 1 pivot changes the solution

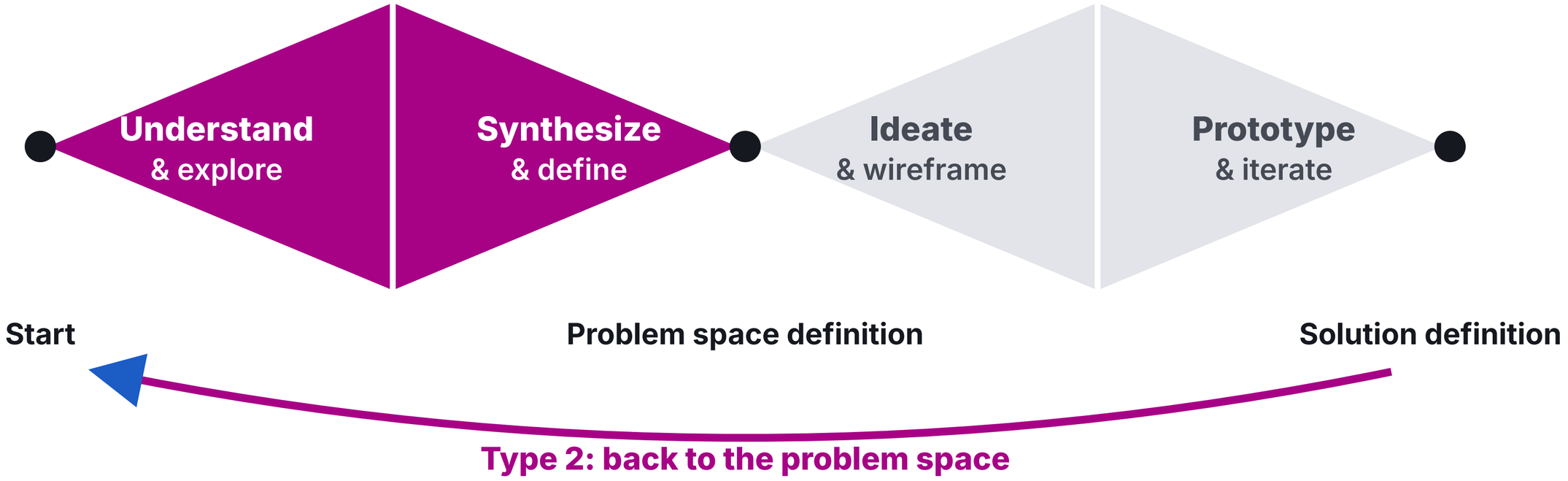
Same problem. App to product, B2B to B2C, sale to subscription



PIVOTING · TYPE 2

# A type 2 pivot goes back to the problem

A new problem space and a clean cut. Slow and hard on the team



INPUT 1 OF 4 · WIDEN IT · THE ANSWERS

# Widen it: several solutions, the line picks

**1**

Why write several solutions before you pick one?

**Side by side beats one by one, and the best may need no software**

**2**

How do you pick the winner?

**By what people did with each, against a line set first, not by what you like**

**3**

What if every solution falls under your line?

**You pivot: type 1 tries another solution, type 2 goes back to the problem**

INPUT 2 OF 4 · CHAPTER 4 OF 9

# Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing

Say in under ten words why your segment would switch, and prove it.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 2 OF 4 · SHARPEN IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# Why would they switch?

**1**

**What is a value proposition?**

**2**

**Who is it for?**

**3**

**How much better must it be?**

VALUE PROPOSITION

# A value proposition matches an offer to a need



CORE PRINCIPLE

# Build something that is

# 10 times better

than what your users have now.

**Not better than a competitor's feature list.**

**FRAMEWORK** The 10x rule of thumb: Reid Hoffman in Peter Thiel's CS183 class (Masters, 2012).

WHY TEN TIMES

# A loss weighs about twice as much as a gain

Mean of 607 estimates. Bars to scale

**How much a change weighs, against a gain of the same size = 1**



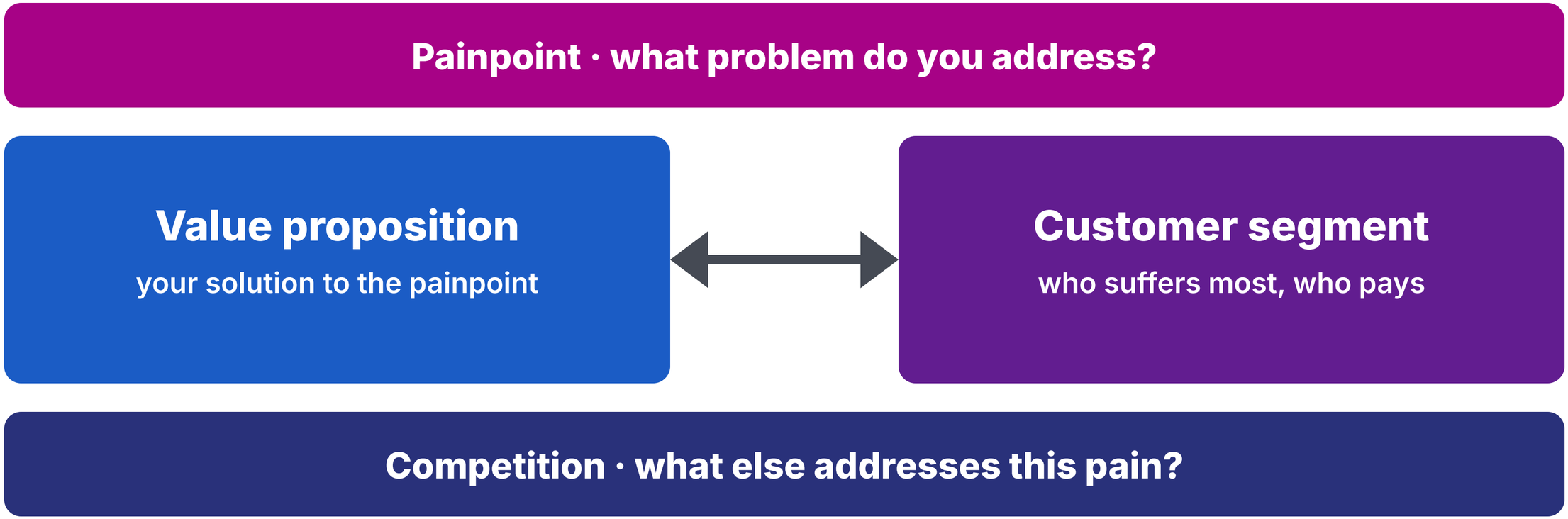

**Switching means losing your habit, your data, your workaround.**

**Gourville calls the gap a 9x mismatch. Practitioners say 10x (Hoffman).**

**RESEARCH** Brown, A. L., Imai, T., Vieider, F. M., & Camerer, C. F. (2024). Meta-analysis of empirical estimates of loss aversion. *Journal of Economic Literature*, 62(2). Samuelson & Zeckhauser (1988). Gourville (2006).

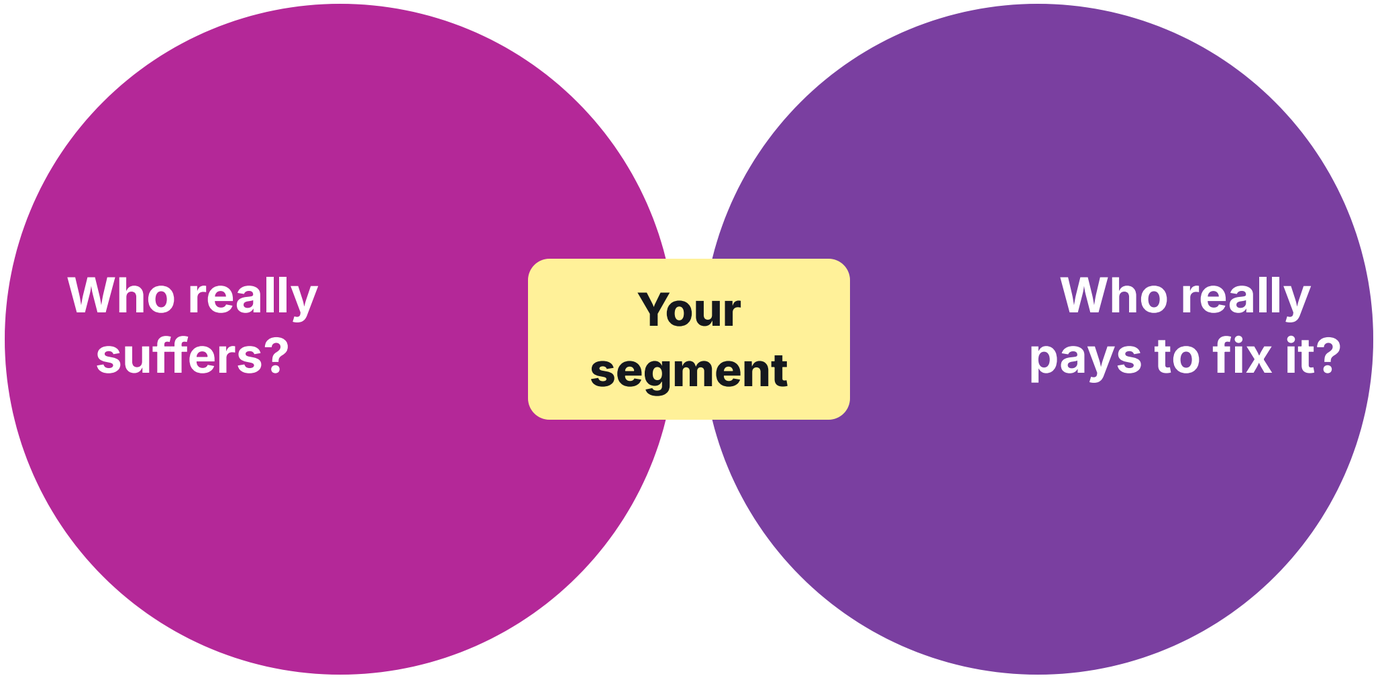
VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS

# Four boxes, one segment



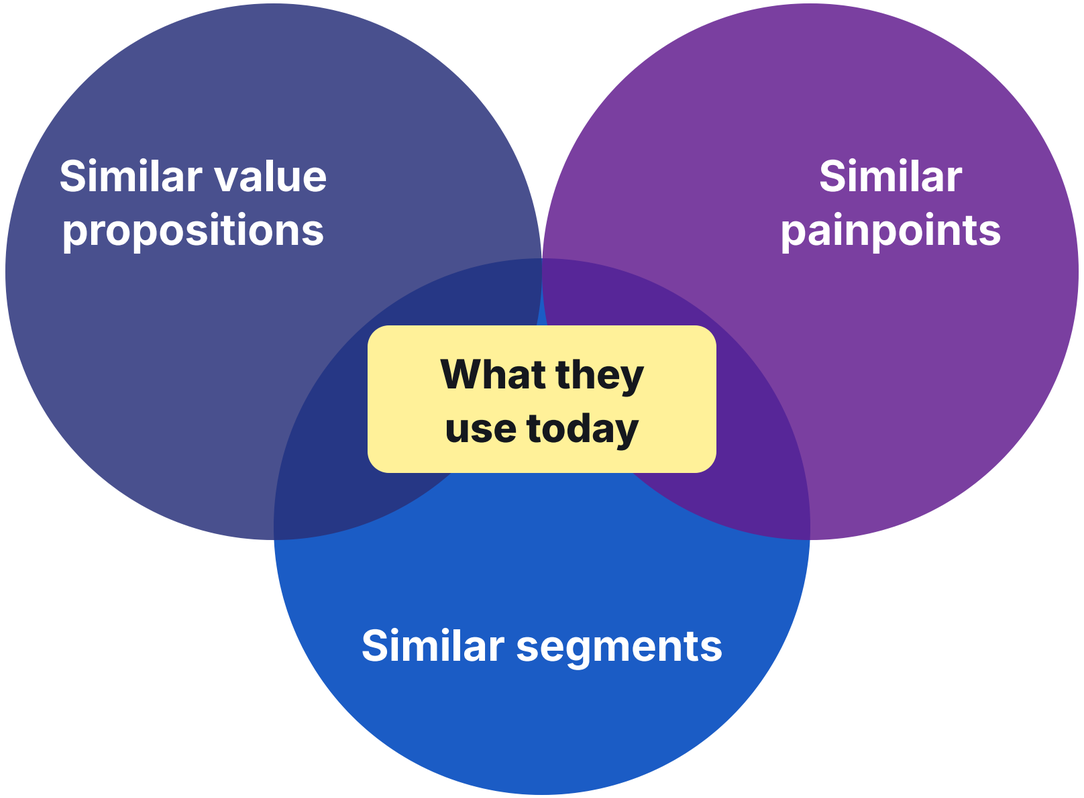
CUSTOMER SEGMENT

# Start where suffering meets willingness to pay



COMPETITION

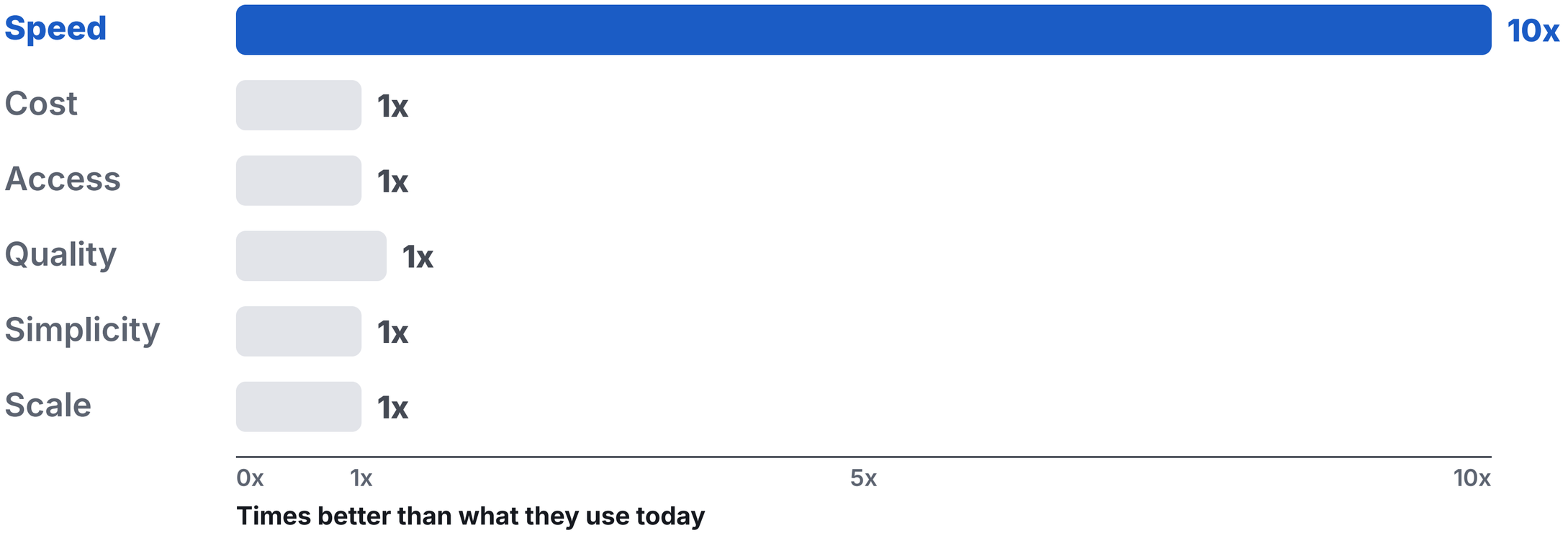
# Your real competitor is what they use today



THE 10X TEST

# Pick one dimension. Be 10 times better there

Under 10 words. 10x on everything is 1x on everything




**FRAMEWORK** Course framework 07, 10x Value Prop Test, gates 1 and 2. Bars illustrative, one dimension against the status quo.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP

# An hour, not a week

Bars drawn to scale

## Today: spreadsheet, Friday check

**1 week = 40 working hours**

## With the alert




**Working hours until the recruiter knows a finalist went quiet**

**"Know within an hour that a finalist went quiet."**

**Speed · proof: heard from 4 recruiters, not yet measured**

**ILLUSTRATIVE** Made-up recruiting venture. A week counted as 40 working hours.

NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

# Write your 10x line

**Segment** — One segment, not everybody

**Status quo** — What they use today

**Dimension** — Speed, cost, access, quality …

**10x line** — Under 10 words

**Proof** — Heard, measured or assumed?

3:00

OUTPUT

**One 10x line per solution**

INPUT 2 OF 4 · SHARPEN IT · THE ANSWERS

# Sharpen it: one segment, one dimension, 10x

**1**

What is a value proposition?

**An offer matched to a need, said in under ten words**

**2**

Who is it for?

**One segment, where suffering meets willingness to pay, against what they use today**

**3**

How much better must it be?

**Ten times better on one dimension, because a loss weighs about twice a gain**

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CHAPTER 5 OF 9

# Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand

Cut your solution to the one feature that delivers its 10x, and fake the rest.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 ~~Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing~~

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CUT IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# How little must you build?

**1**

**What goes into your first dummy?**

**2**

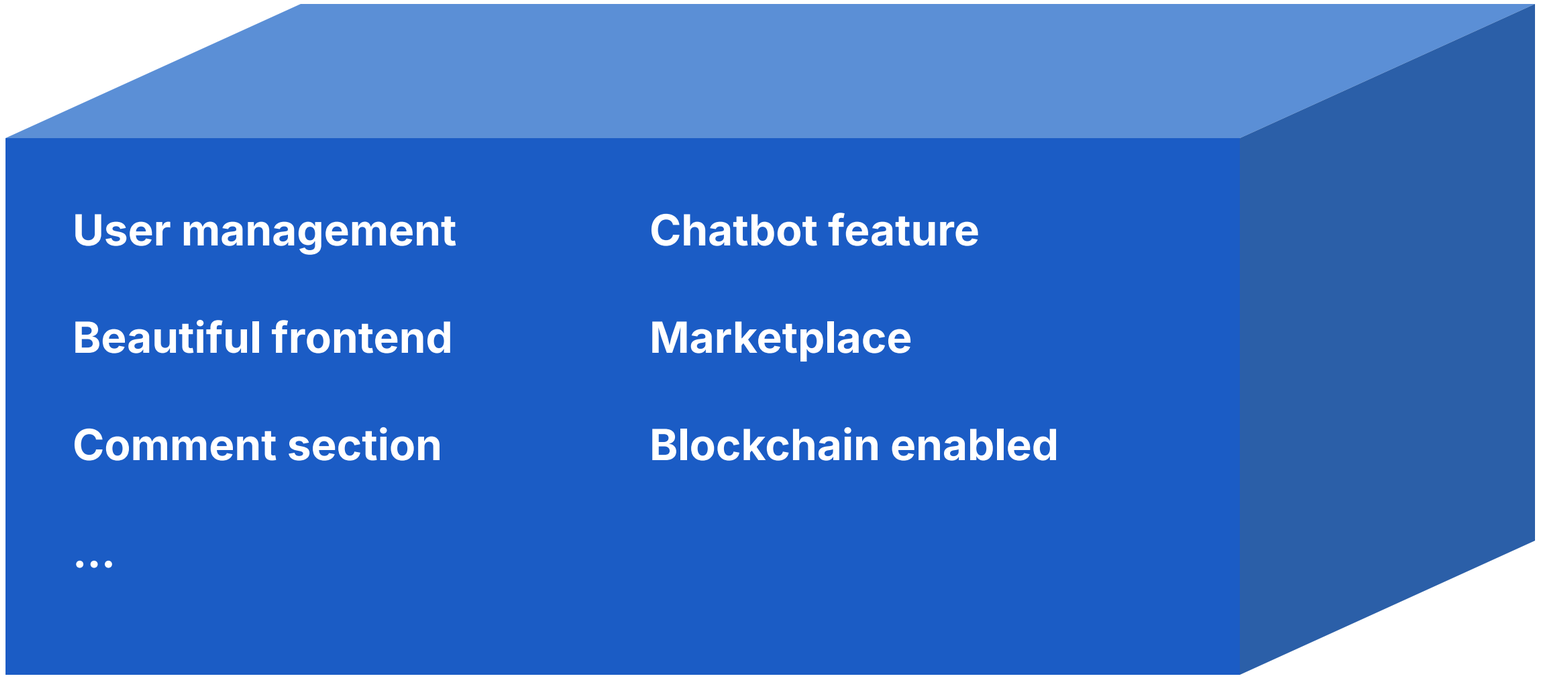
**What may stay fake behind it?**

**3**

**When is it an MVP?**

YOUR PROTOTYPE

# Your first dummy is smaller than you think




Tech doesn't matter

**The one feature**
your users care about

**10x better**

Offensively ugly and slow

PREVIOUSLY · FINDING IDEAS (M02)

# Decide what you won't build

Strong constraints leave few implementations



PAGE VS. DUMMY

# The page names benefits. The dummy builds one

**YOUR PAGE**

Benefit 1

Benefit 2

Benefit 3

Names the 3 to 4 benefits

**YOUR DUMMY**

Feature 1

Builds the one that is 10x

SPEED MATTERS

# One iteration should not take more than

# 4 hours

**Don't lie!!!**
Counting only the time you were "really" working is lying.

TECH SOLUTION & BUSINESS SOLUTION

# Solve the business before the tech

"But I cannot build a maglev-monorail in 4 hours or less!"

**BUSINESS SOLUTION**

Does the market need it?

What will it pay?

**Solve this first.**

It sets your tech constraints.

**TECH SOLUTION**

Can we deliver it at scale?

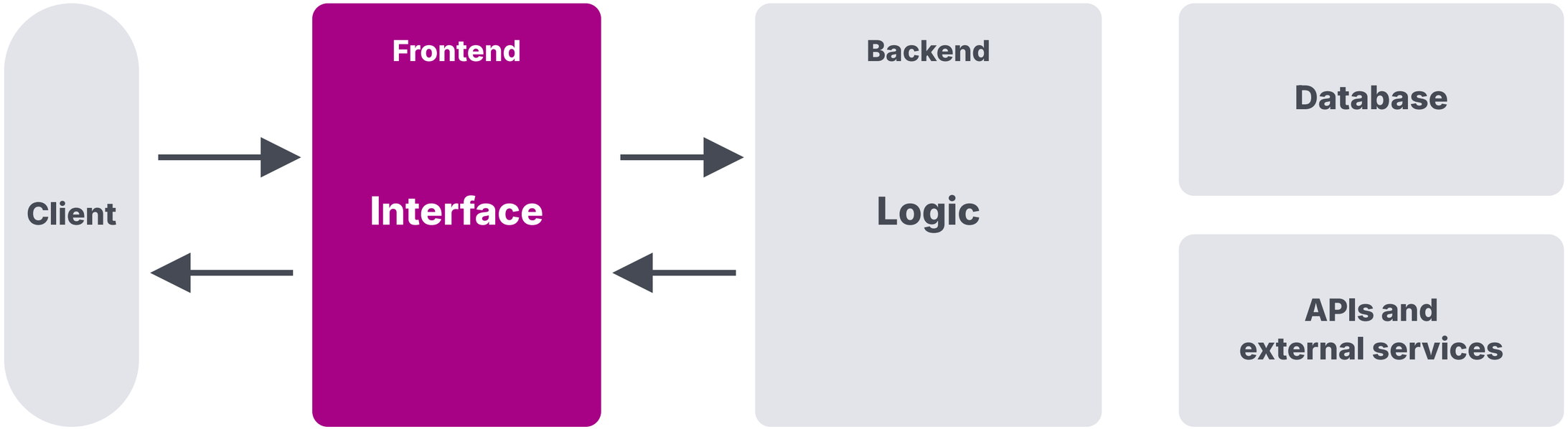
Reliably, on a budget?

Must fit the business.

The simplest one wins.

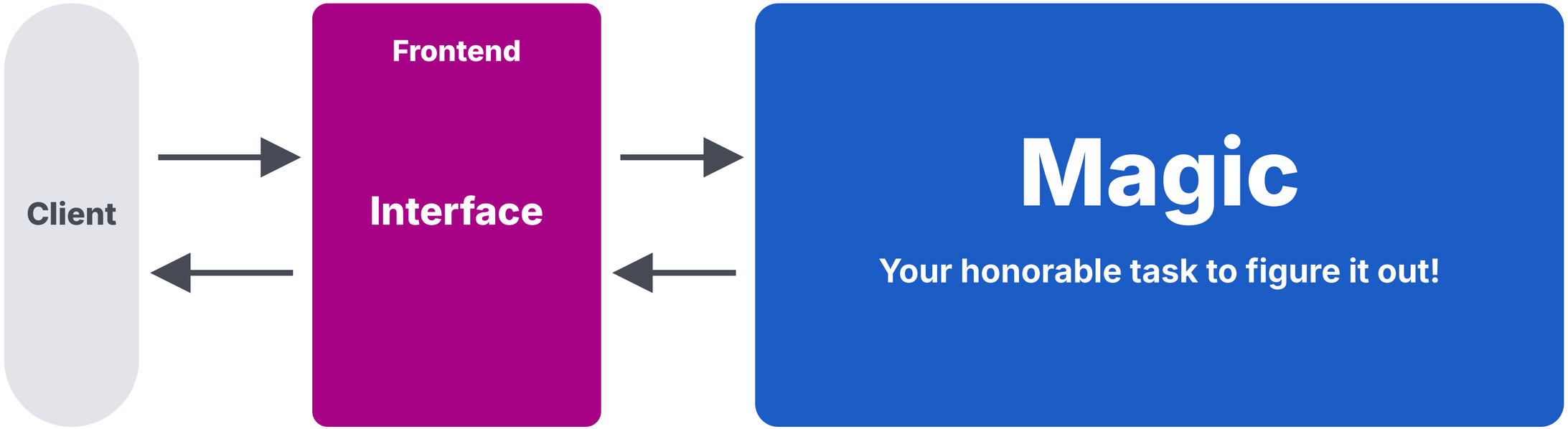
THINK INTERFACE FIRST

# Every app is an interface on top of a lot of work



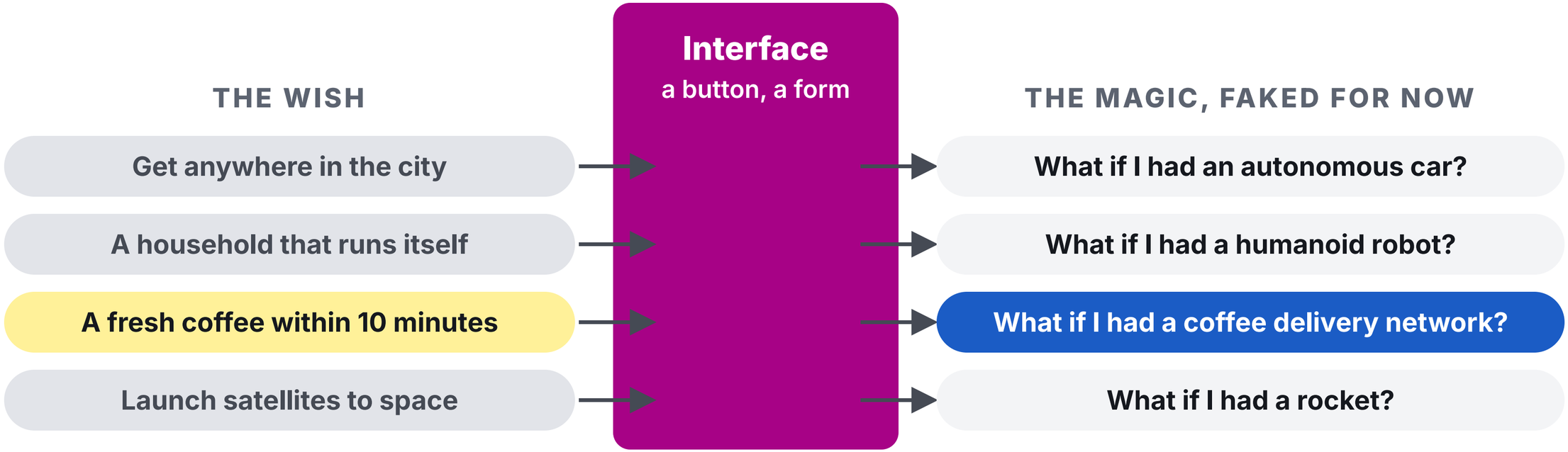
SMOKE AND MIRRORS

# If anything behind it worked, would they love it?



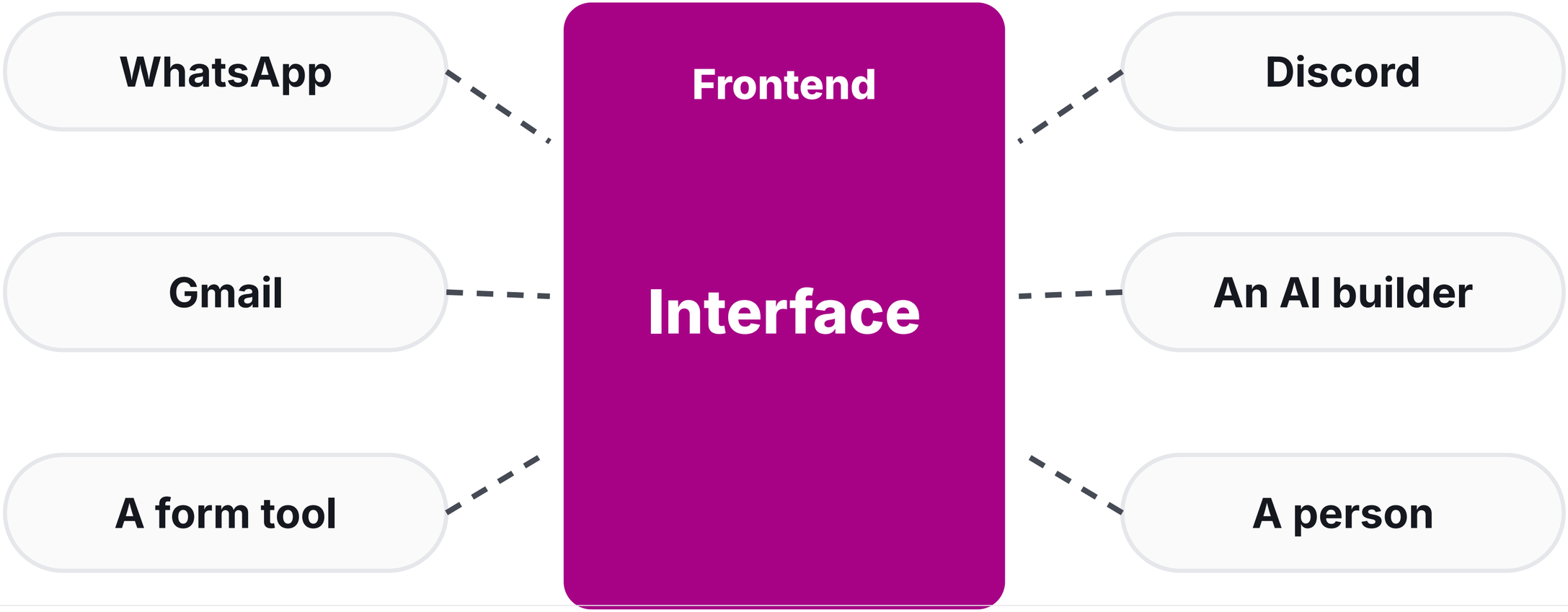
SMOKE AND MIRRORS

# Fake the magic. Test the wish



SMOKE AND MIRRORS

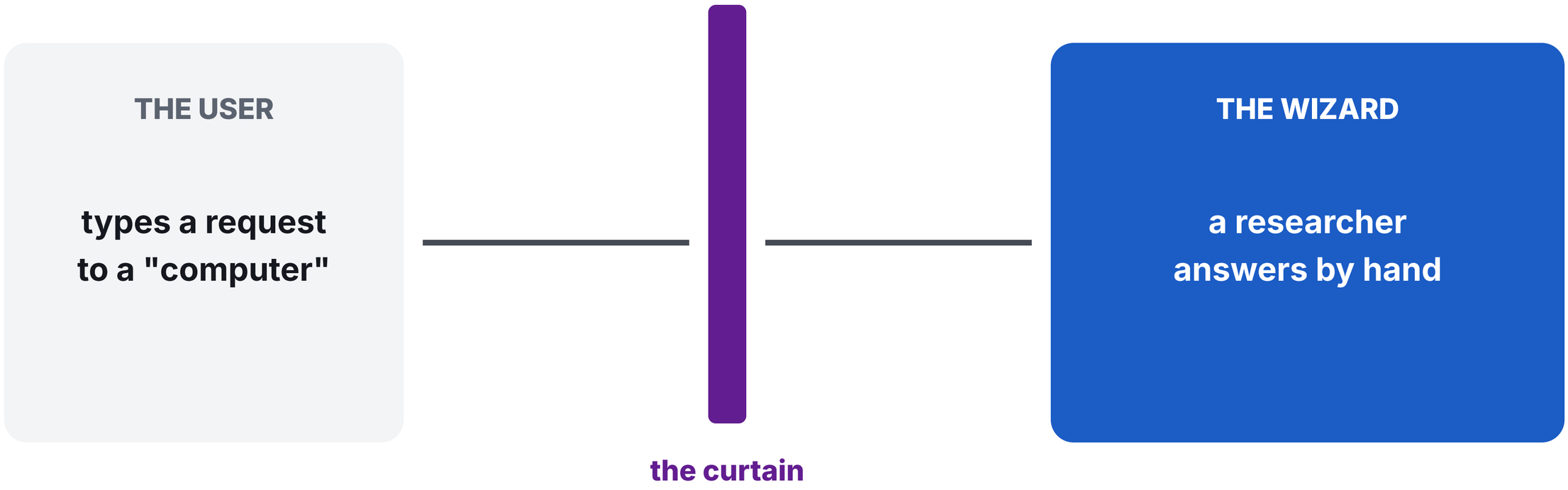
# Customers don't care HOW you do it!



RESEARCH · WIZARD OF OZ

# Behind the curtain, a person plays the computer

The Wizard of Oz method, in use since about 1980




**RESEARCH** Kelley, J. F. (1984). An iterative design methodology for user-friendly natural language office information applications. *ACM TOIS*, 2(1). Gould, J. D., Conti, J., & Hovanyecz, T. (1983). *Communications of the ACM*, 26(4).

# MVP. The smallest thing that can trigger validation (a wallet opening).

"If it can't be paid for, it's not viable — it's minimal and useless." Course Glossary

WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP

# One alert, sent by hand, is an MVP

| | |
|---|---|
| **ONE FEATURE** | The alert when a finalist goes quiet |
| **INTERFACE** | Three screens, the last one says "Book a 2-week trial" |
| **MANUAL** | You check the hiring tool by hand every hour and send the alert |
| **OFFER** | A 2-week trial for one recruiting team, then a monthly price |

NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 3 MINUTES

# Cut to one feature. Split real from manual

**One feature** The one that is 10x

**Interface** What the screen must show

**Manual** What you do by hand behind it

**Offer** What it would cost them

3:00

OUTPUT

**Your MVP in one sentence**

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CUT IT · THE ANSWERS

# Cut it: one feature, the magic by hand

**1**

What goes into your first dummy?

**The one feature that delivers your 10x, and a list of what you won't build**

**2**

What may stay fake behind it?

**Everything behind the interface. A person can play the computer**

**3**

When is it an MVP?

**When it is the smallest offer someone in your segment could pay for**

INPUT 4 OF 4 · CHAPTER 6 OF 9

# Show it: a click dummy people try

Build a click dummy in under an hour and show it to people from your segment.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 ~~Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing~~

05 ~~Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand~~

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 4 OF 4 · SHOW IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# How do people try it?

**1**

**How fast can you build a click dummy?**

**2**

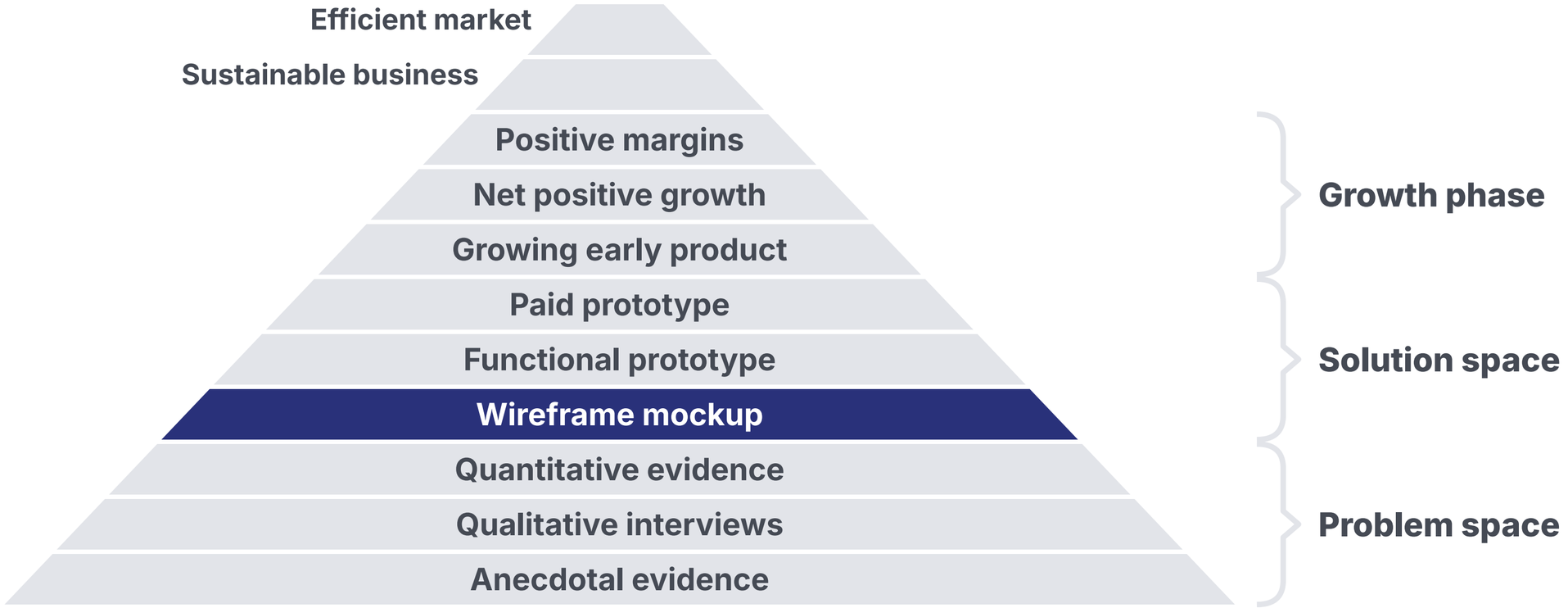
**How do you show it?**

**3**

**What counts as a result?**

THE VERY FIRST MOCK-UP

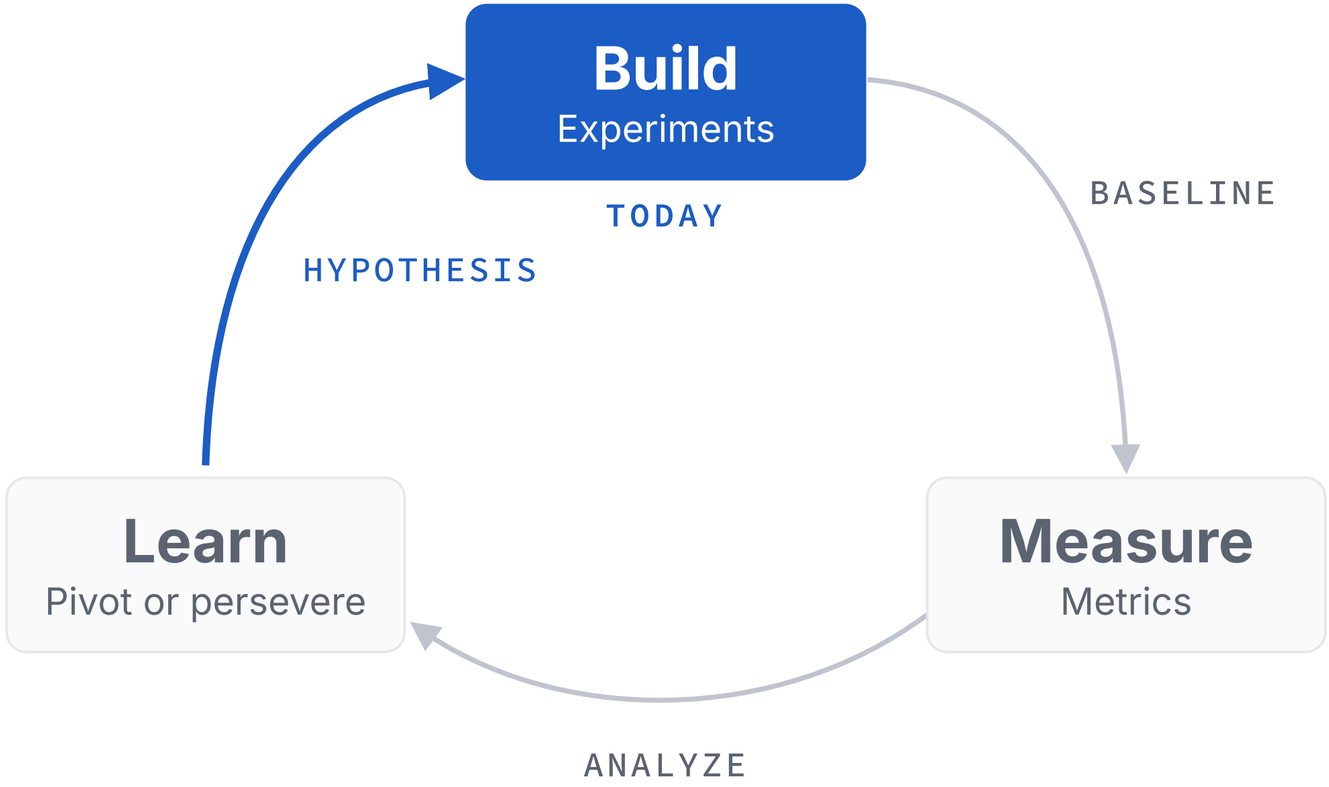
# A click dummy is rung four. Signal, not proof



BUILD-MEASURE-LEARN

# AI tilts the tide towards less engineering

A quarter of YC's Winter 2025 founders said over 95% of their code was AI-written

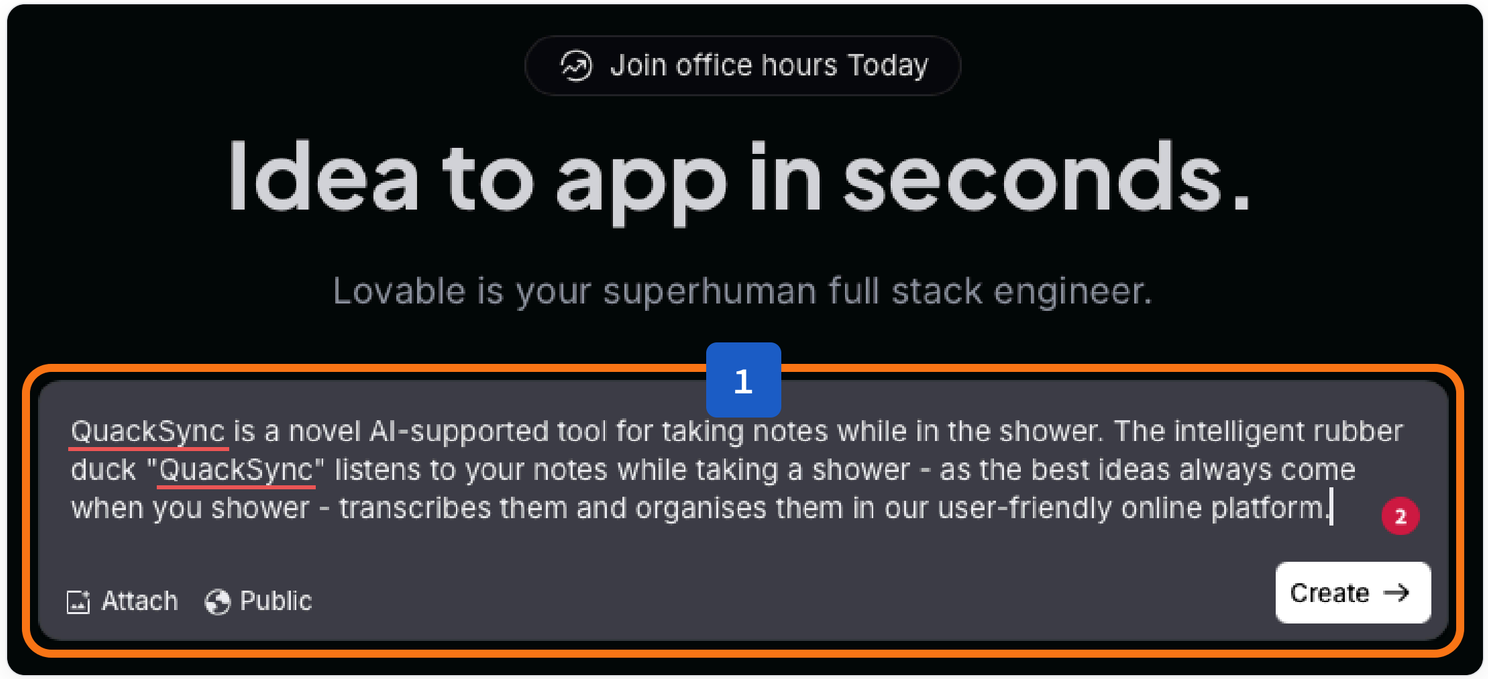



> BUILD **The founder is the product owner, not the engineer. Hours, not weeks.**

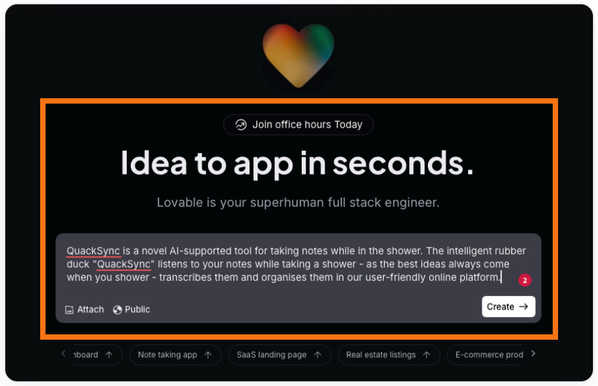
YC Friedman, J., on Y Combinator's Lightcone (2025, 5 March), founders' own estimates. Tan, G. (2025, 5 March), post on X. Build times and the QuackSync run in this chapter.

SHOW THE REAL THING · QUACKSYNC · STEP 1 OF 6

# Paste your value proposition, not a feature list




Segment, pain, value. No tech stack.




1. **Paste your pitch**
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

SHOW THE REAL THING · QUACKSYNC · STEP 2 OF 6

# It asks before it builds. Tick one box

**SCOPE · What should this web app actually include?**

- Marketing landing site
- **User dashboard for notes**
- **Live audio recording + AI transcription**
- **Pre-order / waitlist signup**

**LANGUAGE · Which language(s) for the UI copy?**

- German only
- **English only**
- Both (DE default, EN toggle)

**DESIGN · Generate design directions, or just build?**

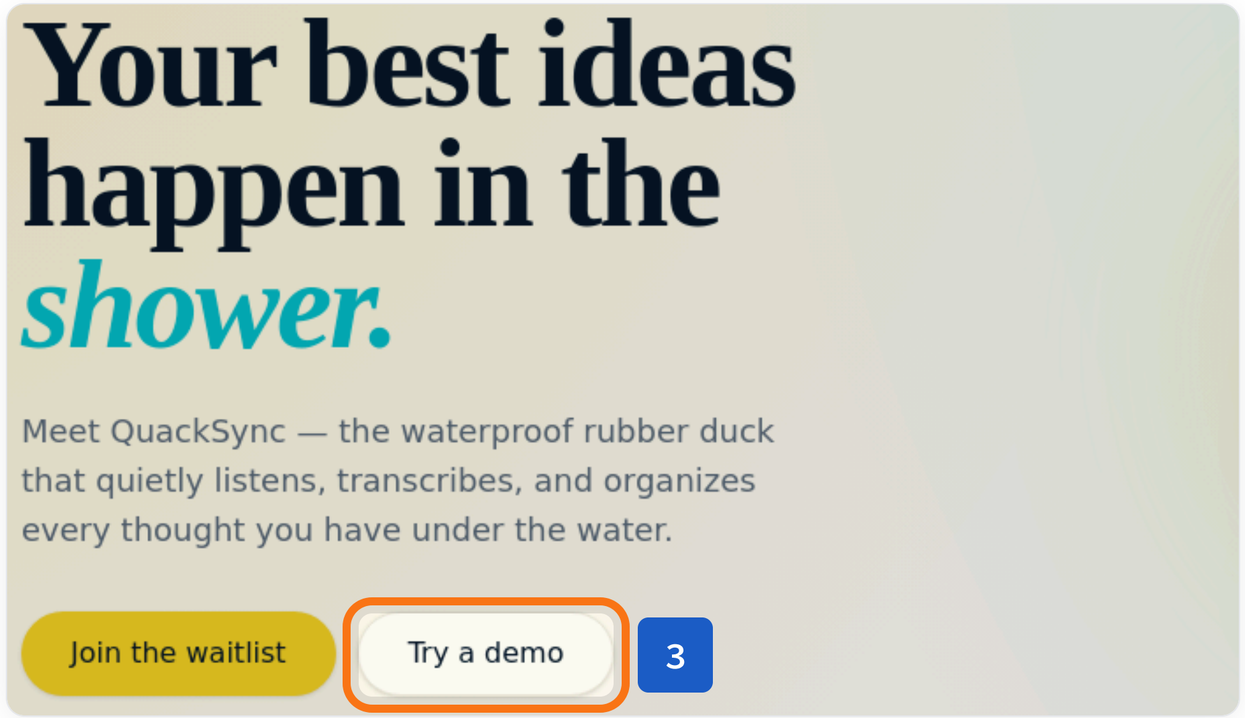
- Show me design directions first
- **Just build it**

1. Paste your pitch
2. **Answer narrowly**
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

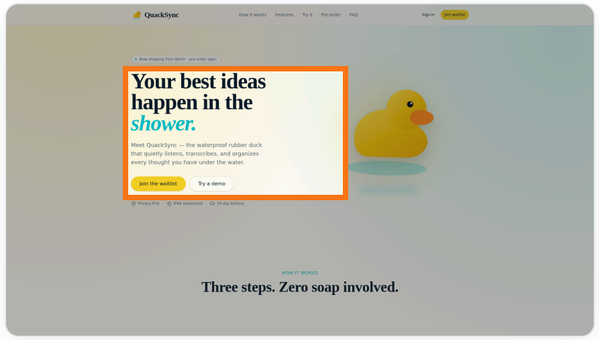
A click dummy needs the one path. Not a dashboard, not audio.

SHOW THE REAL THING · QUACKSYNC · STEP 3 OF 6

# Half an hour later, you can click it



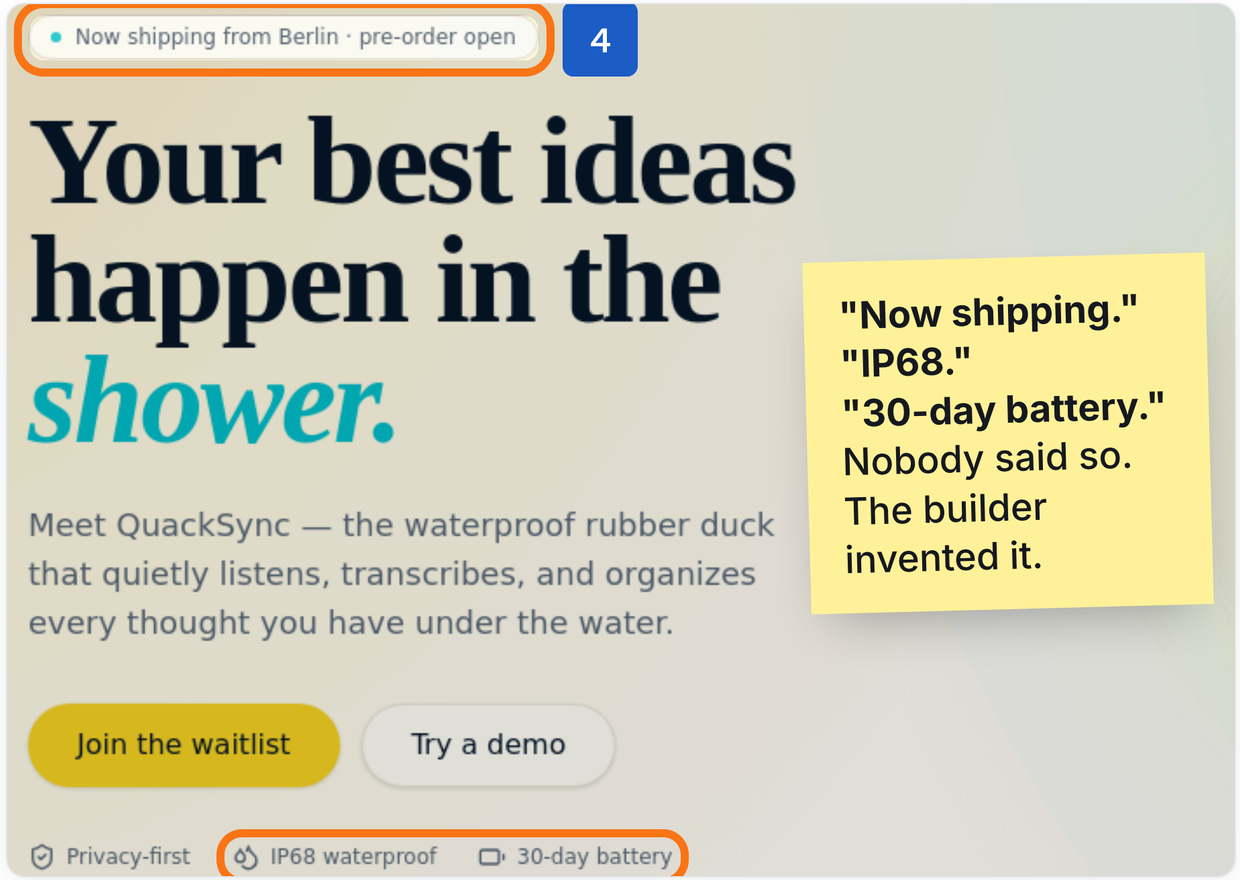

36 minutes from the first prompt to the last edit.

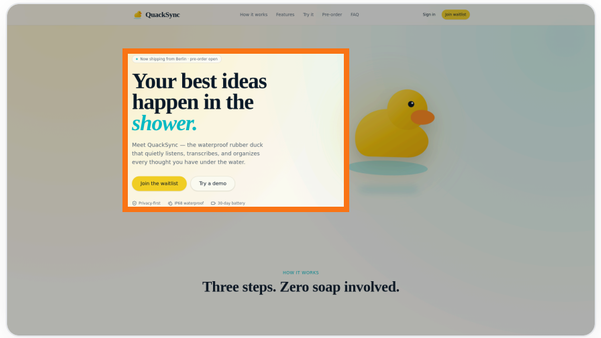



1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. **Click through**
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

SHOW THE REAL THING · QUACKSYNC · STEP 4 OF 6

# Delete what the builder made up

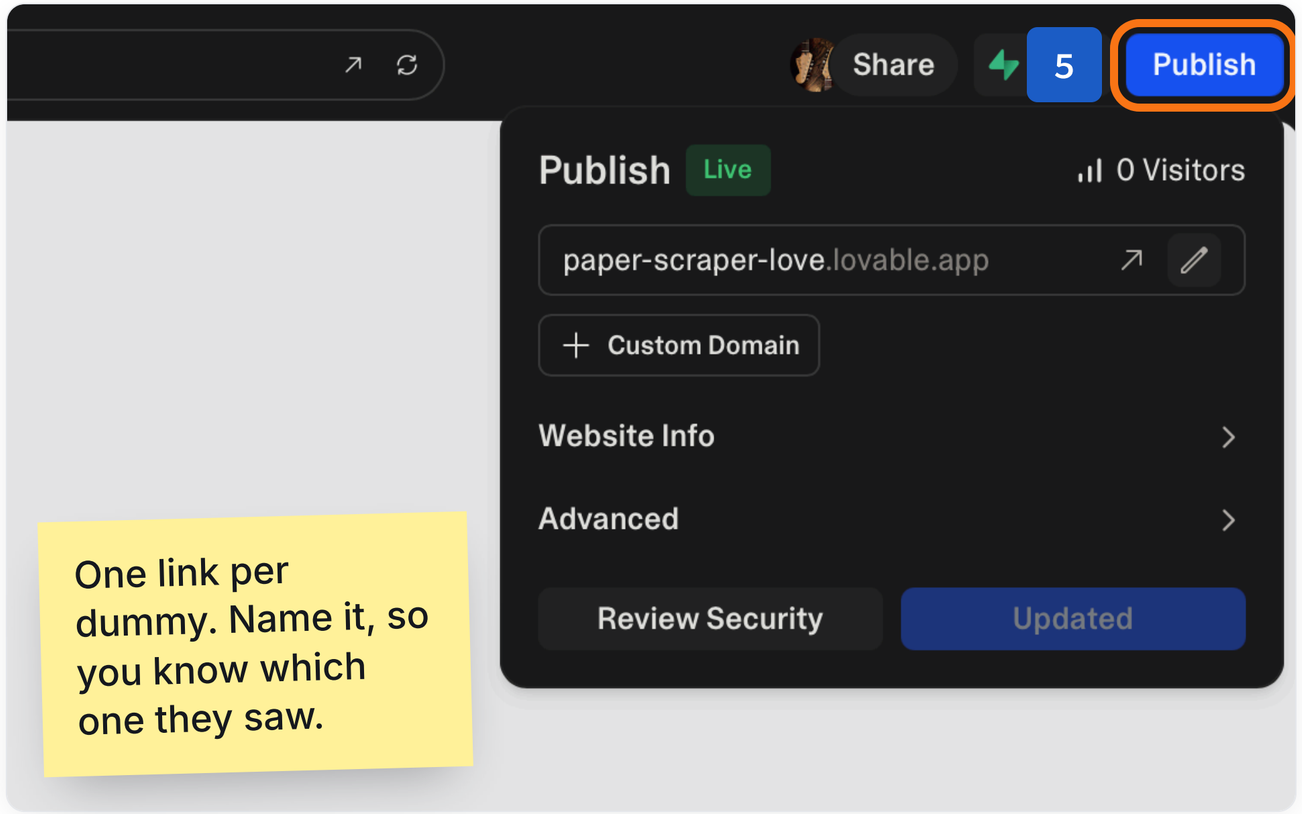


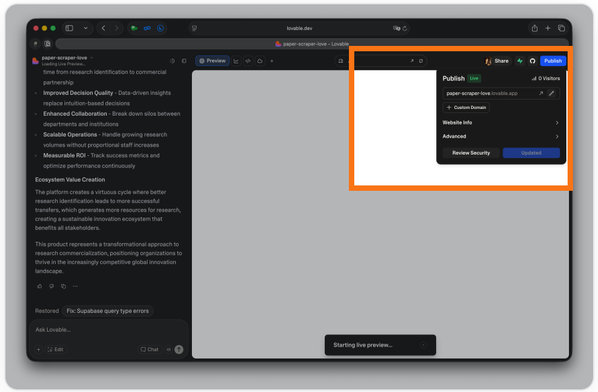




1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. **Delete inventions**
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

SHOW THE REAL THING · STEP 5 OF 6

# Publish, then share one link



1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. **Publish one link**
6. Link your button

SHOW THE REAL THING · STEP 6 OF 6

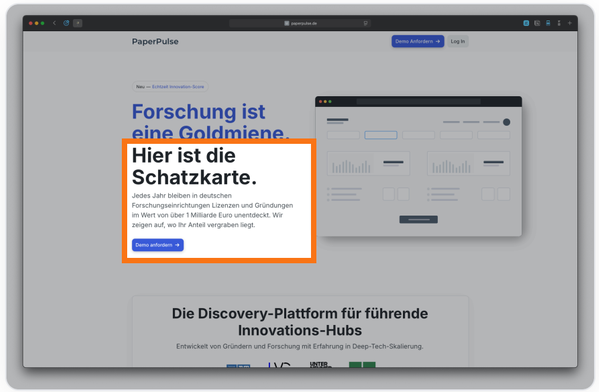
# Put it behind your page's button

## Hier ist die Schatzkarte.

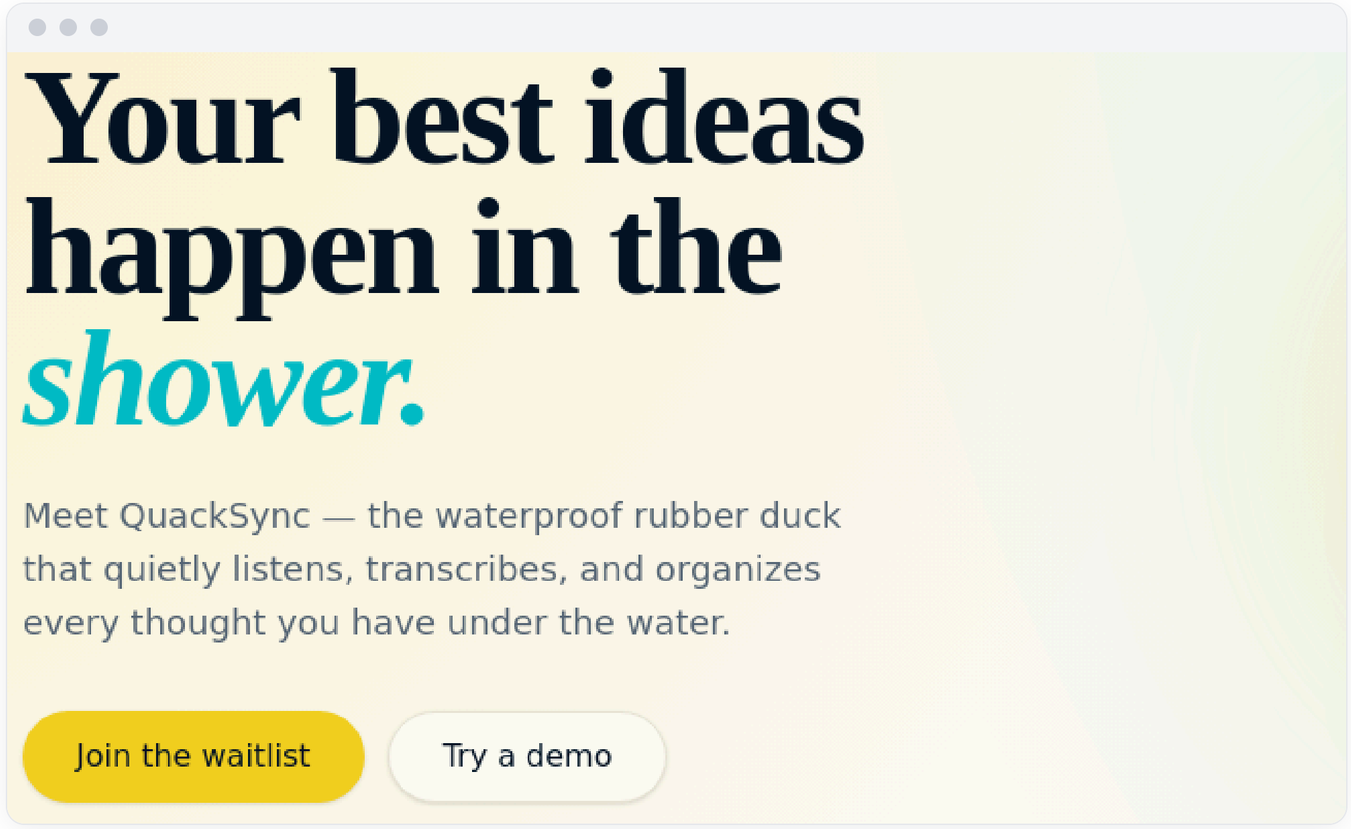
Jedes Jahr bleiben in deutschen Forschungseinrichtungen Lizenzen und Gründungen im Wert von über 1 Milliarde Euro unentdeckt. Wir zeigen auf, wo Ihr Anteil vergraben liegt.

Demo anfordern → 6

Only after your Validating problems (M04) result is logged. The line never moves.




1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. **Link your button**




TOOLS · AS OF OCTOBER 2026

# Any builder works. Pick one

- 🧡 **Lovable**, 5 free credits a day
- 🎨 **Figma Make**, 500 AI credits a month free
- 🧪 **Replit**, 1 free app, offline after 30 days
- 🖼️ **Framer**, 500 AI credits to try

lovable.dev ↗ Figma Make ↗

replit.com ↗ Framer ↗

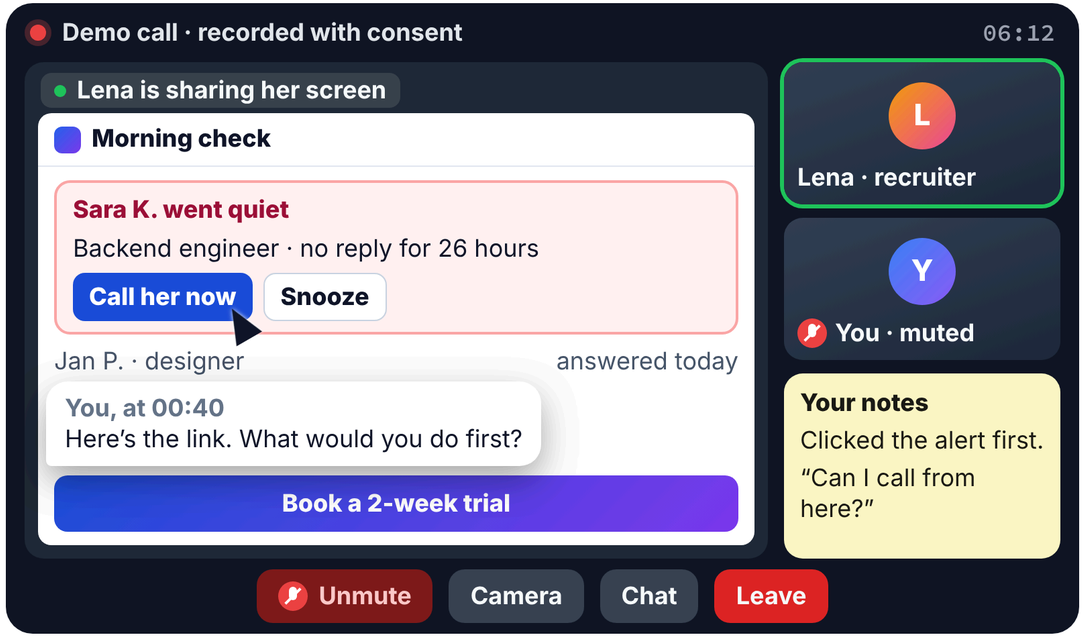
**DATA** Vendor pricing pages, opened 19 October 2026. Blomfield, T. (2025). How to get the most out of vibe coding. Y Combinator. Logos are trademarks of their owners. QuackSync in Lovable, 23 June 2026, cropped.

DEMOS

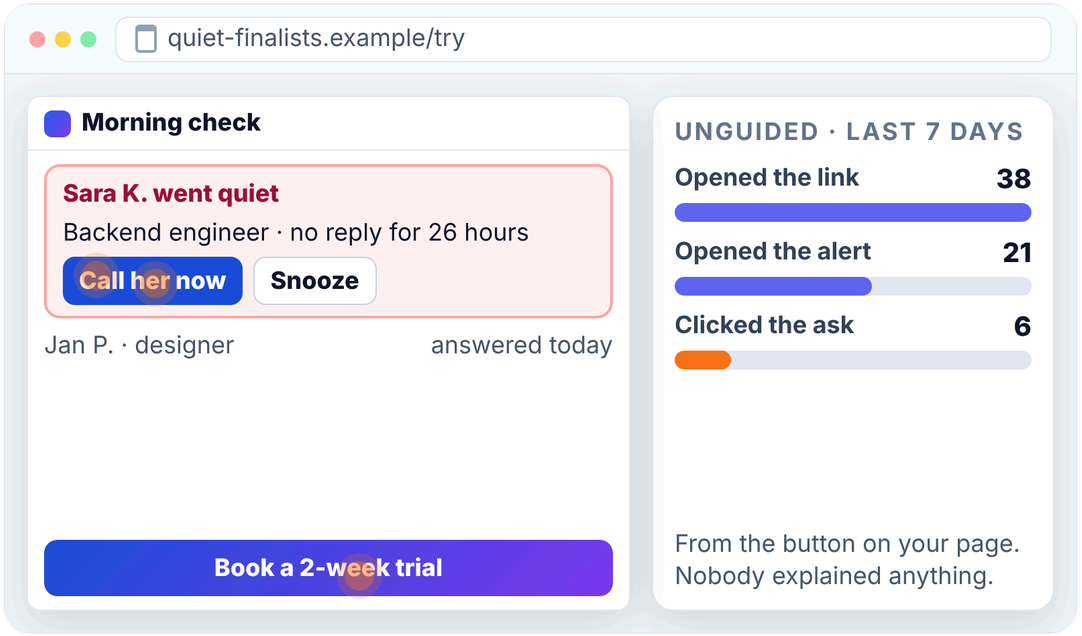
# Use guided or unguided demos

Depending on your use case. Usually both

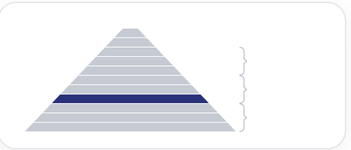
## Guided · you lead and interview




## Unguided · they decide, you reach more




**ILLUSTRATIVE** Both screens prototyped for this course. Names and numbers made up.



GUIDED DEMOS

# They drive. You stay quiet. End with an ask

## 1 · Let them drive

FROM
"Let me show you how it works."

TO
**"Here's the link. What would you do first?"**

## 2 · Ask about today

FROM
"Do you like it?"

TO
**"What did you do the last time this happened?"**

## 3 · End with an ask

FROM
"Would you use this?"

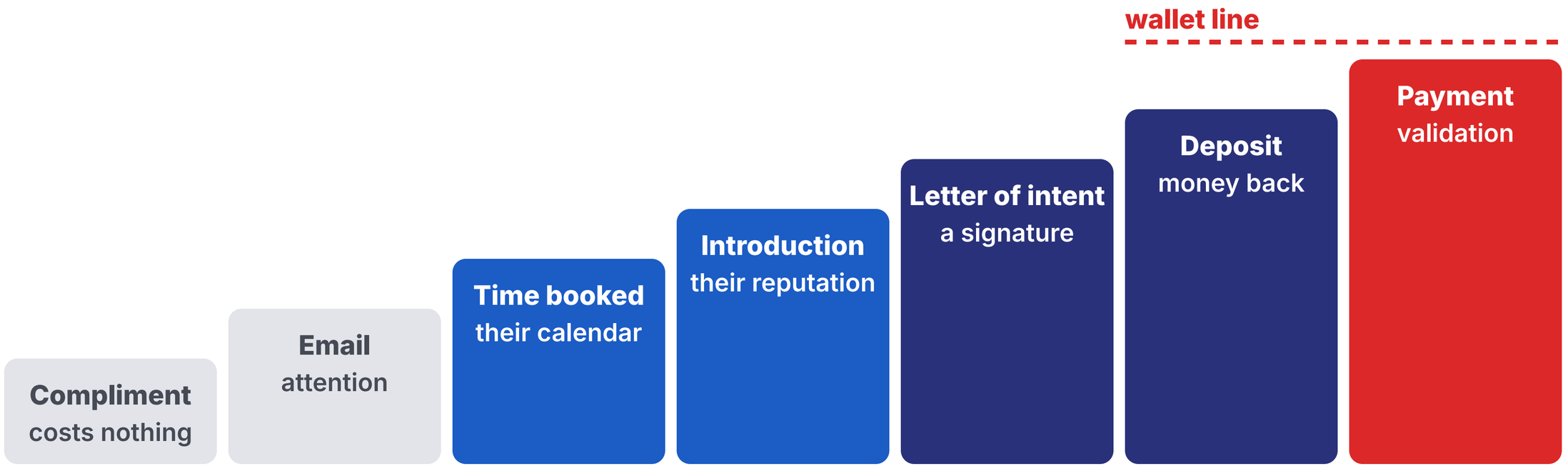
TO
**"Can we book your first trial week now?"**

**FRAMEWORK** Course demo rule. Course framework 01, Mom Test cheatsheet, after Fitzpatrick, R. (2013).

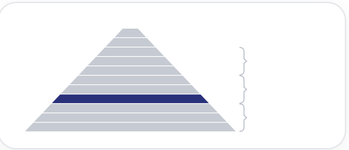
THE ASK

# Climb the ask until it costs them something

Signal below the wallet line, validation above it




**FRAMEWORK** Course framework 01, Mom Test cheatsheet, rule 4 (time, money, reputation or access), after Fitzpatrick, R. (2013). Course Glossary.



RESEARCH

# Rough finds the same problems as polished

Sketches and finished screens, tested side by side

| PAPER SKETCH | POLISHED HTML |
| --- | --- |
| **Usability problems found** | **Usability problems found** |
| **substantially the same** | **substantially the same** |

**But rough prototypes mislead on task times and looks.**
Test whether people want it with the ask, not with polish.

**RESEARCH** Walker, Takayama & Landay (2002). Virzi, Sokolov & Karis (1996). Sauer & Sonderegger (2009). *Applied Ergonomics*, 40(4).

# AI is not paying for your service, real humans are!

AI testers find broken flows. They never count as evidence.

**RESEARCH** Hämäläinen et al. (2023), CHI. Bisbee et al. (2024), *Political Analysis*. Rosala & Moran (2024), Nielsen Norman Group.

SPEED MATTERS

## Before you decide, show every dummy at least

# 7 times

**To people from your segment, in guided demos.**
Then read your line, keep the winner, bin the rest.

NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

# Write your ask

**Who** — Three sign-ups you will message today

**Path** — The 3 screens to the one feature

**Ask** — What it costs them

**If yes** — What happens next

**If no** — What you ask instead

3:00

OUTPUT

**Three names, one ask**

INPUT 4 OF 4 · SHOW IT · THE ANSWERS

# Show it: they drive, you ask

**1**

How fast can you build a click dummy?

**In about half an hour with an AI builder. Any builder works**

**2**

How do you show it?

**Guided demos where they drive and you stay quiet, and unguided behind your page**

**3**

What counts as a result?

**An ask that costs them something. A dummy collects signal, only a payment validates**

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

# Wrap-up and check-out

Two pictures to keep, three questions to reflect on, and your week.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 ~~Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing~~

05 ~~Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand~~

06 ~~Show it: a click dummy people try~~

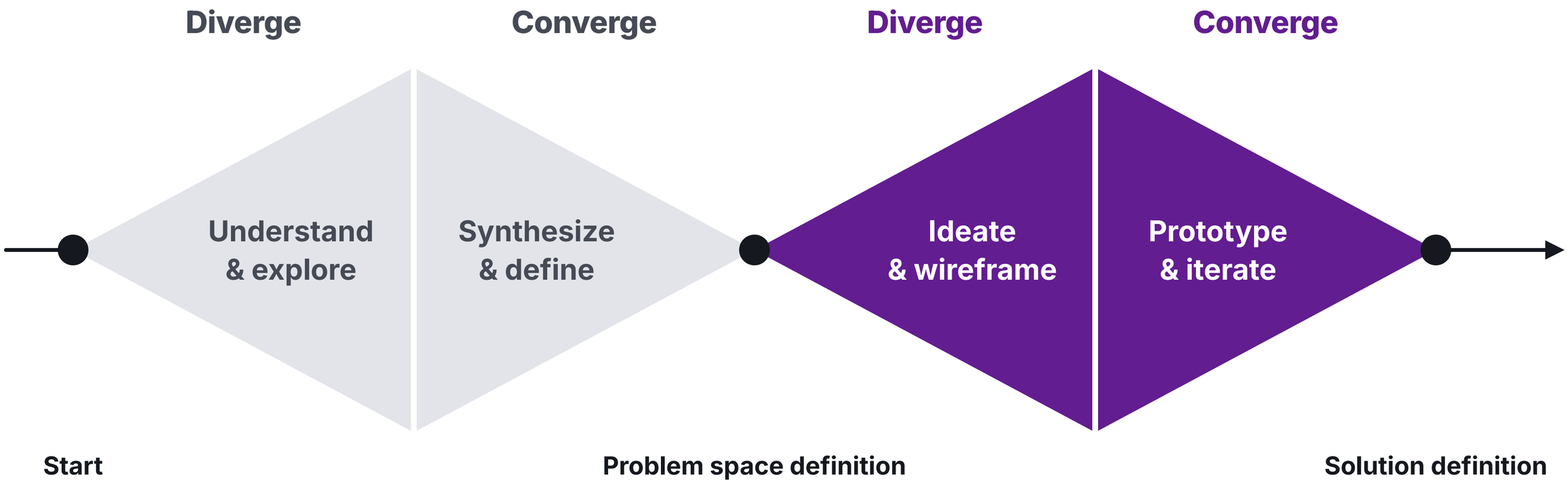
07 **Wrap-up and check-out**

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

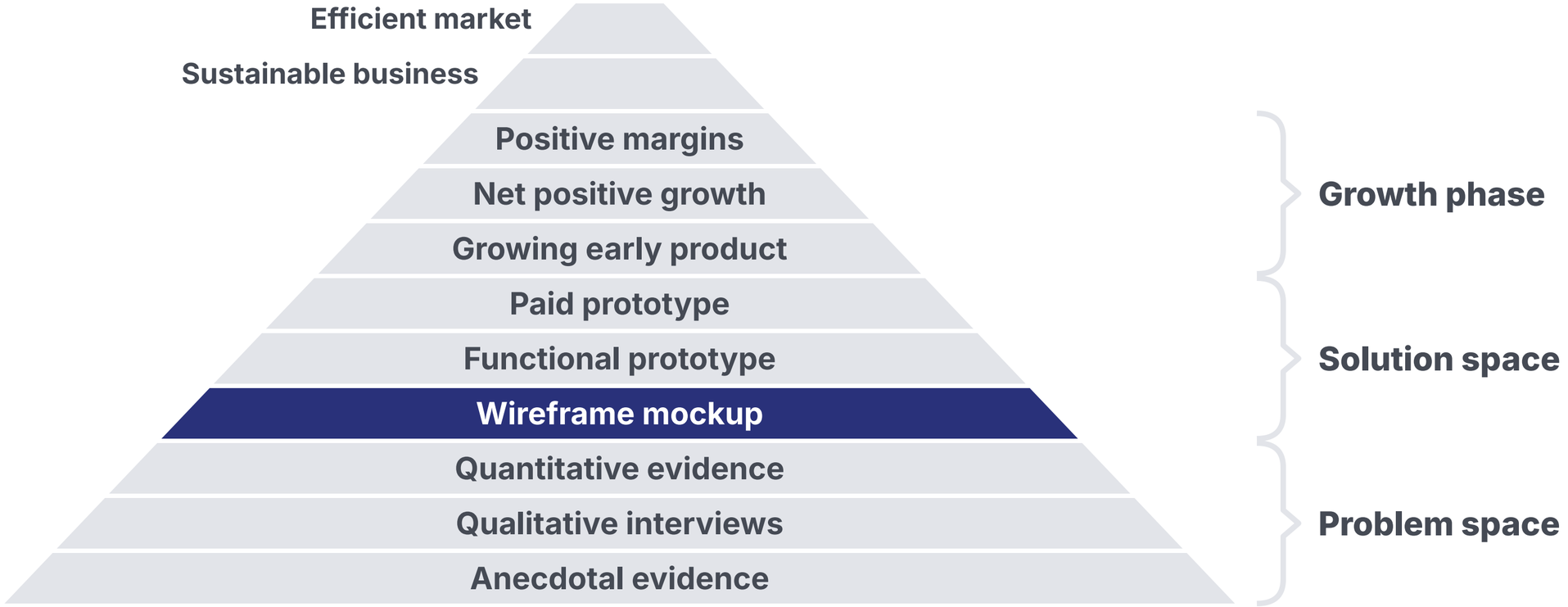
RECAP · TODAY

# You worked the second diamond



RECAP · RUNG FOUR

# From today you climb to the mock-up



REFLECTION 1 OF 3 · THE CONTENT

# What could you apply?



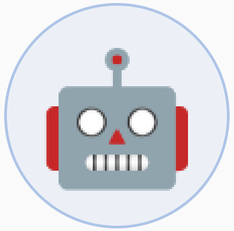
## What could you apply?



## What gave you a hard time?

REFLECTION 2 OF 3 · THE PROCESS

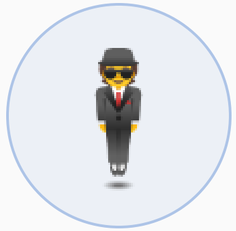
# Man vs. machine



**Where did AI actually help you?**



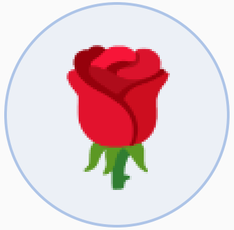
**Where was your genius needed?**



**What are your best hacks to share?**

REFLECTION 3 OF 3 · THE RESULTS

# Rose, thorn, bud



**What was the breakthrough today?**



**What was the hardest part today?**



**What is an idea/feature you didn't have time to finish, but want to explore later?**

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

## Build one click dummy per founder and show the dummies in 15 guided demos per student with people from your segment, at least 7 per dummy, each ending in an ask that costs them something.

# 15 demos each

The learning floor is one click dummy per team and 5 such demos per student.

**Your line: fewer than 2 of the first 7 people from your segment accept a dummy's ask, and that dummy goes.**

HOMEWORK · HOW TO DO IT

# Let them drive. End with an ask

1. **Build with your AI builder in 4 hours or less.** Rebuild, don't patch.
2. **Book sign-ups first,** then interviewees, then your segment's groups.
3. **Let them drive.** Share the link in a call. Watch, stay quiet.

! **Watch out.** Explaining makes it a pitch.

4. **End with the ask,** a trial slot or a pre-order. Only a payment validates.
5. **Converge midweek.** Keep the dummy with the most accepted asks.

6. **Write your MVP.** One feature, what stays manual, the price.
7. **Put the winner behind your page's button** once your Validating problems (M04) result is logged. Those clicks are signal, not demos.
8. **Get a blind second opinion.** Give an AI your raw notes, minus hypothesis and names. Note where it disagrees.

HOMEWORK · WHAT YOU COME BACK WITH

# Good is heard, counted and asked for

| | GOOD | WEAK |
|---|---|---|
| 10X | "An hour, not a week", heard in 9 demos | "Faster", assumed |
| DEMOS | 45 guided, 3 dummies | 12 friends clicked |
| ASKS | 8 trials booked, 1 deposit | "Keep me posted" |

**ILLUSTRATIVE** What you come back with, Solution space (M05) homework. The examples follow the made-up recruiting venture.

# Sources in this deck

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Sauer, J., & Sonderegger, A. (2009). The influence of prototype fidelity and aesthetics of design in usability tests. *Applied Ergonomics*, 40(4), 670–677.

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Virzi, R. A., Sokolov, J. L., & Karis, D. (1996). Usability problem identification using both low- and high-fidelity prototypes. *CHI 96*, 236–243.

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# See you next time!

MODULE 05 · WORKSHOP · 90 MINUTES

# Workshop: Build a click dummy, book the demos

Every founder builds one click dummy and books the first demos.


01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 **Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos**

09 Case discussion

WORKSHOP · STEP 1 OF 3

# Go wide, then pick by 10x

1 STEP 1 · 25 MIN

## GO WIDE, THEN PICK BY 10X

**Real options, judged against what your segment uses today**

→ Read your Validating problems (M04) line next to your result
→ Name the status quo and what it costs
→ Three solutions per founder, one without software, then ask AI
→ Keep one each, under 10 words, one 10x dimension
→ Log the line, dated, before anyone sees a dummy

**Output** One pick per founder, a dated line

**Minutes** 25

25:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 2 OF 3

# From text to interface

2 STEP 2 · 40 MIN

## FROM TEXT TO INTERFACE

**A dummy that shows one feature and ends with an ask**

→ Cut to the one feature your segment cares about
→ The screen shows the outcome, the rest stays manual
→ Prompt the builder: one path, 1 to 5 prompts
→ The last screen asks for a trial slot, LOI or pre-order
→ Rehearse with another team. Classmates never count

**Output** One link per founder, ending in an ask

**Minutes** 40

40:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 3 OF 3

# First demos, then commit

3 STEP 3 · 25 MIN

## FIRST DEMOS, THEN COMMIT

**Leave with demos on the calendar**

→ Message sign-ups, Problem space (M03) interviewees, then segment groups
→ Run a demo now if someone answers
→ They click, you watch, log it in the Interview Log
→ Each student picks floor or full bar
→ Set your midweek day for reading the line

**Output** Booked demos, targets, midweek day

**Minutes** 25

25:00

ARRIVED EMPTY-HANDED?

# Start from your interviews

No sign-ups? Work from your interviews, proof assumed. Switched segment? Post your dummy in the new segment's groups.

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

## Build one click dummy per founder and show the dummies in 15 guided demos per student with people from your segment, at least 7 per dummy, each ending in an ask that costs them something.

# 15 demos each

The learning floor is one click dummy per team and 5 such demos per student.

**Your line: fewer than 2 of the first 7 people from your segment accept a dummy's ask, and that dummy goes.**

# See you next time!

MODULE 05 · CASE DISCUSSION · ABOUT 90 MINUTES

# Case discussion: Freeletics

Stand with three Munich founders in April 2013 and decide what goes on sale by Monday.


01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 **Case discussion**

CASE · FREELETICS GBR, MUNICH, A THURSDAY IN APRIL 2013 · VOTE 1 OF 2

# There is no money left. What is on sale on Monday?

OPTION 1

**An e-book with the workouts**

OPTION 2

**The weekly parts at €1.99 as they stand**

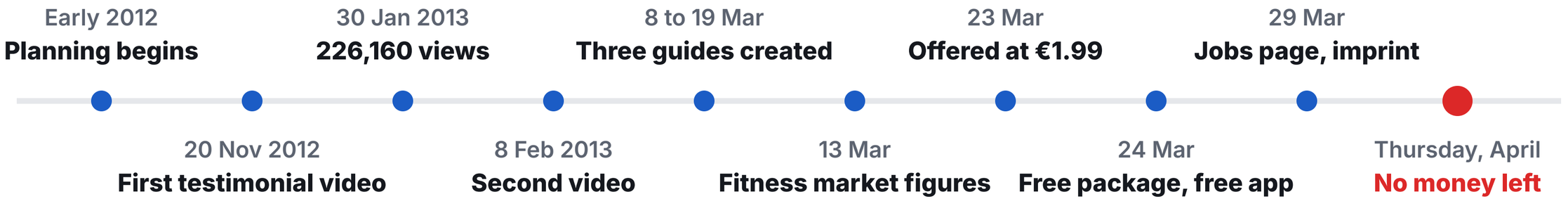
OPTION 3

**Nothing new until the app**

**DATA** Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, "What Could Be Sold by Monday". Option 1 is the one a founder named. Options 2 and 3 were plainly available.

CASE · WHAT HAPPENED UNTIL APRIL 2013

# Everything before one Thursday

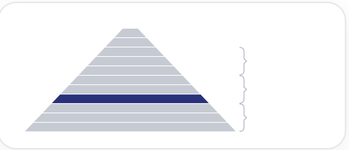


CASE · EXHIBIT 1

# What the shop offered, 23 to 29 March 2013

| PAGE | CAPTURED | WHAT IT OFFERED | PRICE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Home page | 24 March | A Basic Package of workouts for an email address | Free |
| Product list | 23 and 29 March | Cardio&Strength, Cardio and Strength Training Guide | €1.99 each |
| Cardio&Strength guide | 24 March | Part 1, workouts and schedules for one week, download link within 15 minutes | €1.99 per part |
| Cardio guide | 28 and 29 March | Parts 1 and 2 | €1.99 per part |
| App | 24 March | A free training app, linked to Apple's App Store | Free |
| Jobs | 29 March | A call for mobile developers | |

**DATA** Compiled by the case writer from Internet Archive captures of freeletics.myshopify.com, 23 to 29 March 2013 (case Exhibit 1, shortened).



CASE · STATUS QUO · 15 MINUTES

# Against what did Freeletics compete?

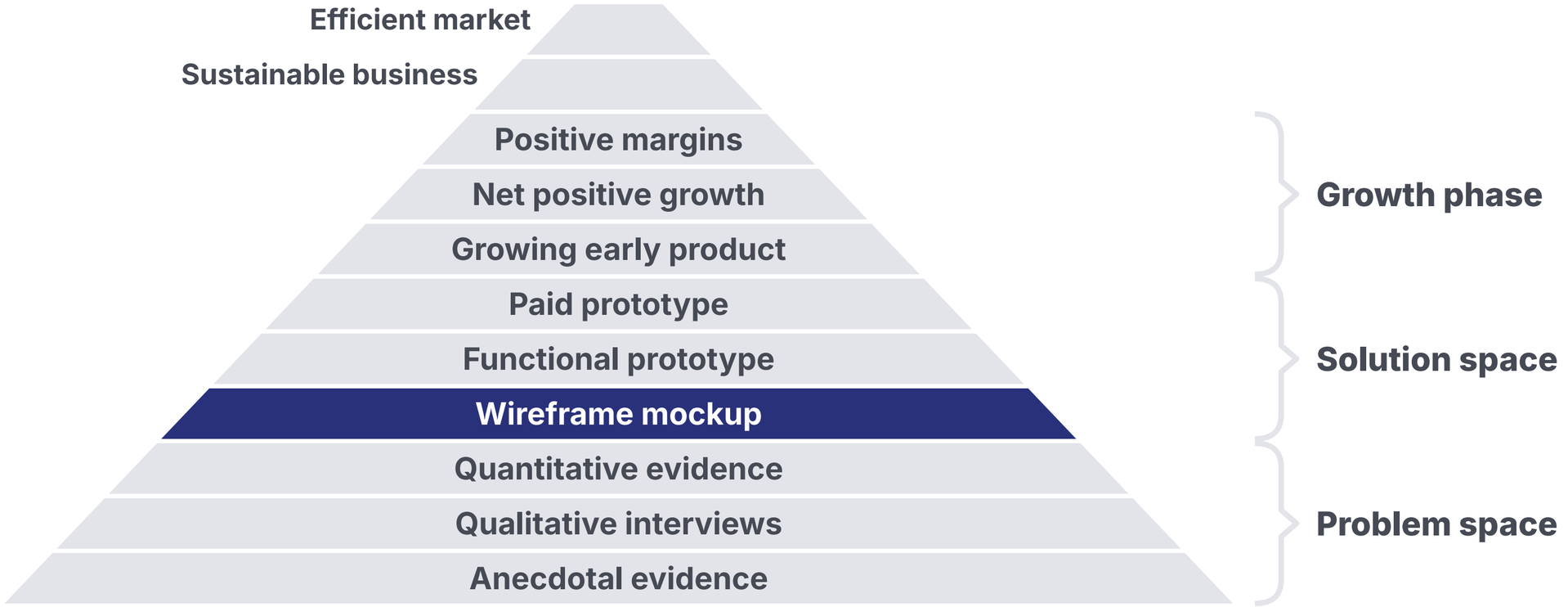
And where could it be ten times better?

| GERMAN FITNESS MARKET, END OF 2012 | VALUE |
|---|---|
| Members of fitness facilities, 2012 | 7.9 million |
| Fitness facilities | 7,566 |
| Average membership fee, gross, 2012 | €45.42 |
| Industry revenue | €3.8 billion |
| Market share of chains | 47.2 percent |

**DATA** DSSV and Deloitte, press release on "Der deutsche Fitnessmarkt 2013", 13 March 2013, translated by the case writer (case Exhibit 4, shortened). The fee's period is not stated, about €40 a month by the case writer's check.

CASE · EVIDENCE · 15 MINUTES

# What did people do that cost them something?



CASE · THE SMALLEST OFFER AND THE LINE · 30 MINUTES

# What could ship by Monday, and what stays manual?

Then: which form would you have kept, and by what line?

| **Forms on 29 March**<br>with or without software | **What people did**<br>heard, measured, assumed | **Signal or payment**<br>which could validate? | **The smallest offer**<br>shows, manual, price |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

**DATA** Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, Exhibits 1 and 3. Column 4 holds your answers to pre-read question 2.

CASE · VOTE 2 OF 2

# Same question. Who moved, and why?

OPTION 1

**An e-book with the workouts**

OPTION 2

**The weekly parts at €1.99 as they stand**

OPTION 3

**Nothing new until the app**

**DATA** Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, "What Could Be Sold by Monday". Option 1 is the one a founder named. Options 2 and 3 were plainly available.

# See you next time!